UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

Lead Sales and Services Associate (LSSA)

Participant Guide

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Employee Resource Management

Lead Sales and Services Associate (LSSA)

Participant Guide

United States Postal Service
Employee Resource Management
475 L'Enfant Plaza SW
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A Commitment to Diversity

The Postal Service is committed to fostering and achieving a work and learning environment that respects and values a diverse workforce. Valuing and managing diversity in the Postal Service means that we will build an inclusive environment that respects the uniqueness of every individual and encourages the contributions, experiences and perspectives of all people.

It is essential that our work and learning environments be free from discrimination and harassment on any basis.

In our classrooms, on the workroom floor, in casual conversation and in formal meetings, employees and faculty are asked to encourage an open learning environment that is supportive of everyone.

Course materials and lectures, classroom debates and casual conversation should always reflect the commitment to safety and freedom from discrimination, sexual harassment and harassment on any prohibited basis. Instructors and class participants are expected to support this commitment.

If you find course material that is presented in the classroom or in self-instructional format that does not follow these guidelines, please let an instructor know immediately.

If classroom discussions do not support these principles please point that out to the instructor as well.

Diversity is a source of strength for our organization. Diversity promotes innovation, creativity, productivity and growth, and enables a broadening of existing concepts.

The Postal Service's policy is to value the diversity of our employees, customers and suppliers, and to do what is right for our employees and the communities we serve, thereby ensuring a competitive advantage in the global marketplace.

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Introduction to Lead Sales and Services Associate Training

Objective:

Upon completion of this course participants will be able to assume their responsibilities as Lead Sales and Services Associates.

Instructional Methods:

Presentation and discussion with time to go over the LSSA Worksheet

The facilitator will use the following instructional methods throughout the course:

- Lecture
- Discussions
- Role Play
- Group Discussions
- Exercises
- Presentations
- Brainstorming
- Demonstrations
- Group Activities
- Review

Where possible, a local expert could be used to familiarize participants with local procedures.

Topics:

Introductions

Housekeeping and comfort issues

Administration items

Course objectives

Course structure

Course schedule

Course content

Materials you use

LSSA Worksheet

Participant Material Used:

Participant Guide

Student Workbook

LSSA Worksheet

Media Required:

None

Introductions

Introduction of Participant(s)

- Name
- Work location
- Work Experience
- Expectations of this training

Housekeeping

- Phone numbers for emergencies
- Restrooms
- Vending machines and water fountains
- Vehicle parking
- Breaks/Lunches
- Fire exits
- Cellphones turned off

Administrative Duties

Sign-in sheet.

Course Objectives

At the completion of this training you will have the necessary tools and guidance to excel as a Lead Sales and Services Associate. You will leave this course with the knowledge of performing proper procedures, how to "Grow Revenue," and the documentation required for your unit.

This jointly developed training course is designed to provide the newly assigned Lead Sales and Services Associate (LSSA) with the knowledge and skills needed to perform their duties. It is also designed for Window Technicians (T-7) and Clerks, Finance Station in need of brush-up or refresher training. It includes instruction in elements such as revenue generation, interpersonal skills, customer relations, postal products and services, and security of funds.

Course Structure

The training will be administered through e-learning courses, classroom courses and an on-the-job training (OJT) session.

The classroom training is 16 hours, consisting of classroom instruction, active learning experiences through role play, presentations, demonstrations, discussions, and hands-on practice.

After the classroom training, you will have 16 hours of on-the-job training (OJT). This is designed to give one-on-one training with a retail coach specific to the tasks you will be performing as an LSSA.

This classroom course consists of 6 modules.

Course Schedule and Content

The course will consist of the following modules:

- Introduction and LSSA Worksheet
- Module 1 – Roles and Responsibilities
- Module 2 – Leadership
- Module 3 – Communications
- Module 4 – Unit Operations
- Module 5 – Daily Unit Financial Report
- Module 6 – Customer Service and Revenue Generation

The next two days of classroom instruction are designed to provide you with the knowledge you will need to perform the duties of an LSSA.

We will review topics in which you are already familiar and build on what you already know.

You will see a document titled LSSA Worksheet. Let's turn to it now and discuss its purpose and how to use it.

LSSA Worksheet

At the end of each module you will complete the LSSA Worksheet. This is a tool we will use to determine your experience and knowledge with certain aspects of the course materials. It is very likely that some of the materials presented are very familiar to you and will have a good comfort level.

Other items introduced may be new and the assessment tool will allow us to identify those areas in which more time will be needed.

In addition, certain procedures and information presented are best completed in the On-the-Job portion of your training. Although some items may be introduced in the classroom, your training for these items will take place on the job.

Following the two days of classroom instruction, new LSSA's will be provided with 16 hours of OJT. After you have completed The LSSA Worksheet, it will become your own individualized learning program to supplement your OJT. Using this approach we are confident you will have all the tools needed to perform your duties in an efficient and professional manner.

This course will enable you to have pride in your position, increase your customer service skills, and give the tools needed to earn respect as the team CAPTAIN at the counter line!

Module 1: Roles and Responsibilities

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Explain how a Lead Sales and Services Associate differs from a Sales and Services Associate
- Identify and explain duties and responsibilities of a Lead Sales and Services Associate

Time Allocated for Module:

- 1 Hour

Instructional Methods:

- Presentation
- Activities
- Group Discussion

Summary:

- LSSA Position Description

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Materials Required:

- PowerPoint Presentation
- Projector
- Rip Charts

Upon completion of this module participants will understand how Lead Sales and Services Associates (LSSAs) differ from Sales and Services Associates (SSAs). Participants will also understand the duties and responsibilities of Lead Sales and Services Associates. Finally, participants will be able to clearly differentiate window services from administrative /miscellaneous duties.

LSSA Position Description

LSSAs may perform tasks differently based on the size of the unit and the level of responsibility given by the unit supervisors. It's vital that we understand what the LSSA position requires to perform the duties correctly and efficiently.

The Lead Sales and Services Associate and Sales and Services Associate share some common duties and responsibilities that support the retail unit. However, there are many responsibilities that are unique only to the LSSA. In the following section we will highlight and discuss those unique responsibilities.

LEAD SALES & SERVICES ASSOCIATE (P7-07) OCCUPATION CODE: 2320-0009

Functional Purpose:

Performs a variety of sales and customer support services for products including; stamps, stamped paper, postal cards, philatelic products, and special promotional items with or without direct supervision. **May work alone or as a working leader, providing administrative and technical guidance to one or more clerks assigned to retail and post office operations.**

Operational Requirements:

This position is for use in Customer Service facilities with retail operation windows.

DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES:

1. Performs any variety of sales and customer services at a retail window such as maintaining sufficient inventory of and selling stamps, stamped paper, other retail products and services and may use a computerized system, accepting and delivering packages and accountable mail; issuing and cashing foreign and domestic postal money orders; accepting and responding to customer claims and inquiries, and providing information to the public regarding postal regulations. Rents post office boxes, receives rental payments, conducts reference checks, and completes related forms.

2. *Communicates and provides administrative and technical guidance to retail and post office operations employees assigned to the unit, informing them of changes or clarifications in policies, procedures, operations, schedules, and regulations. Ensures that work is performed efficiently.

3. *Forecasts and maintains a separate stamped inventory to fill requisitions submitted by other retail clerks assigned to the offices.

4. *Prepares a local bank deposit and/or a consolidated funds bank deposit. Prepares and maintains unit accounting records of retail activities.

5. *Conducts or witnesses transfers of fixed credits between employees as required, assisting in the physical count of stock. Reviews fixed credits periodically and recommends adjustments if necessary. Examines and ensures the integrity of security containers assigned to employees for the storing of their fixed credit and reports lack of conformity with security regulations.

6. Conducts product inventories by counting items on hand; accounts for items on display; and verifies and records sales floor inventory and shrinkage. Brings inventory discrepancies and shrinkage reports to the attention of the appropriate supervisory presence. Maintains an adequate supply of materials required for the operation of a retail office.

7. *Processes and/or accepts and verifies applications for redeemed stamps and stamped paper. Prepares and submits necessary stock for destruction.

8. *Instructs and advises individual employees in correct financial and retail sales procedures.

9. *In accordance with the directives of the supervisory presence, plans, directs, organizes and monitors retail related programs projects and the work of people to meet unit goals, including coordinating and scheduling work hours. Supplies leadership necessary to secure a customer friendly environment, encourages professional appearance and work habits to accomplish effective and pleasant customer relationships. Makes Supervisor approved entries to correct time and attendance records and retains required supporting documents.

10. Provides product and service information to customers, including informing customers regarding special offers and the layout of the store; refers customers to sales and promotional programs by promoting products based on customer needs. Answers customer inquiries.

11. Maintains appearance of store by setting, arranging, and replenishing displays and merchandise racks; ensures display and selling areas, work stations, and storage areas are presentable to customers. Checks and maintains post office self-service kiosk.

12. *Trains new employees to ensure quality service.

13. *Maintains records, files and submits reports, as assigned.

14. May verify presort and bulk mailings of all classifications; computing and maintaining on a current basis mailers' credit balances.

15. In addition, may assign and clear accountable items and distribute mail as required.

16. *Performs other duties as assigned.

Questions / Answers

Instructions: Use the LSSA position description to answer the following questions. Respond with Yes or No along with the number of the supporting duty and responsibility.

1. Does the LSSA position description include the requirement to provide administrative and technical guidance to retail and post office operations employees?

2. Are LSSAs required to perform sales and customer service at the retail window?

3. Does the LSSA position description require LSSAs to train new employees to ensure quality service?

4. LSSAs are not required to supply leadership necessary to secure a customer friendly environment.

5. The LSSA position description allows the LSSA to schedule employees with the direction of a supervisor?

6. LSSAs have a responsibility to see that an adequate supply of materials is maintained in the unit.

7. LSSAs cannot instruct, advise, and correct financial and retail sales procedures.

8. LSSAs cannot prepare and submit stock for destruction.

9. Can an LSSA prepare and consolidate funds as per local bank deposit procedures?

Summary

As you can see, the Lead Sales and Services Associate is a key position in helping the retail unit be successful. Both Sales and Services Associates and management look to you for support and leadership. As Lead Sales and Services Associates you will lead a variety of retail and customer support activities.

Knowing your role and responsibilities is vital to your continued success. You are a leader and must lead by example and help everyone participate in making the retail unit run efficiently. As you progress through the training you will learn more about your role and responsibilities as well as develop your skills to be successful as a Lead Sales and Services Associate.

***Note: TACS training for LSSAs is required when making entries to correct time and attendance records and retaining required supporting documents. TACS entries to time and attendance records will be approved by supervisors.**

Module 2: Leadership

Objective:

- Define leadership
- Identify the qualities of an effective leader
- Provide examples of leading by example

Time Allocated for Module:

- 1 hour

Instructional Methods:

- Group discussion
- Activities

Summary:

- Leadership

Participant Material Used:

- Participant guide

Media Required:

- PowerPoint presentation
- Projector

For Further Information:

- For more information see eLearning course LSSA - Enhancing the Leadership Role #10022304 and Advancing the Retail Customer Experience #10022086.

Leadership

Leadership may be defined as:

- A process of social influence in which one person can enlist the aid and support of others in the accomplishment of a common task.
- A person who successfully encourages others to follow his/her lead and influences colleagues to work toward an objective in which the goal is of benefit to the group.

As LSSAs, you are leaders within your offices. You are considered a captain or the "go to" person within the unit. Your peers rely on you for your knowledge and resourcefulness while your supervisor relies on you to help build the team, share expectations for the unit, and motivate them to reach unit goals.

Leadership Qualities

Lead by Example

As an LSSA, you have an opportunity to interact and influence people daily. Whether meeting with a supervisor about scheduling, discussing issues or policy with peers, or assisting a customer at the window or in the lobby, everything you do effects the unit. As the "captain" of this "team" the best way to show leadership is to **lead by example**. Leadership has been described as doing the right thing. When you walk the walk, it sets the tone for others to follow.

By leading by example you provide an opportunity for those in your unit to see how a situation should be handled. Something as simple as wearing the proper uniform or the way you call a customer to the window can go a long way in providing guidance to those around you. If you always follow the proper procedures and share why, there is a good chance that others will also follow your example. These things can assist in building pride, commitment, positive attitudes, and cooperation among your coworkers.

What are some other things you could do to lead by example?

Leadership embodies many things you do as an LSSA and is tied to things we've covered today. Leadership behaviors are applied in everything from communication and team building to revenue generation.

Leadership - Motivation

Part of being a leader is helping to motivate the group to reach unit goals and maintaining their focus. Your peers will also look to you to keep them informed. Recognizing team members and the unit for successful work also builds team unity. These are a few things effective leaders do.

Occasionally, things do not go exactly as planned. Everyone has a story of something that happened at your location that was "out of the ordinary." It could have been a unique conflict, a tough situation, or a situation that "sparked a new thought or viewpoint.

The facilitator will divide the class into groups of two. Use the questions below to interview each other and record your answers.

How do you motivate your unit?

_____

_____

How do you keep your team meaningfully informed?

_____

_____

How do you maintain your team's focus on specific goals?

_____

_____

How do you recognize successful work within the team?

_____

_____

Think of a situation where the answer was not readily available and you had to think critically to resolve the issue. Critical thinking is a key component of leadership. Your peers will look to you for answers to unique situations when resolutions are not clear.

The facilitator will divide participants into two teams. Provide examples of Postal situations where you have witnessed or experienced critical thinking. Each team will designate a spokesperson to share the team's examples.

Some ideas for your examples:

1. A creative twist on a situation or issue
2. A clever improvisation - "dancing on your feet"
3. A pleasant surprise
4. An Aha moment
5. Something that generated a great deal of excitement
6. A conflict resolved
7. A breakthrough insight or solution
8. A really tough situation
9. A blindside experience

Do you view yourself as a leader?

Do you have leadership qualities?

Do you motivate your team?

Do you lead by example?

Being Resourceful

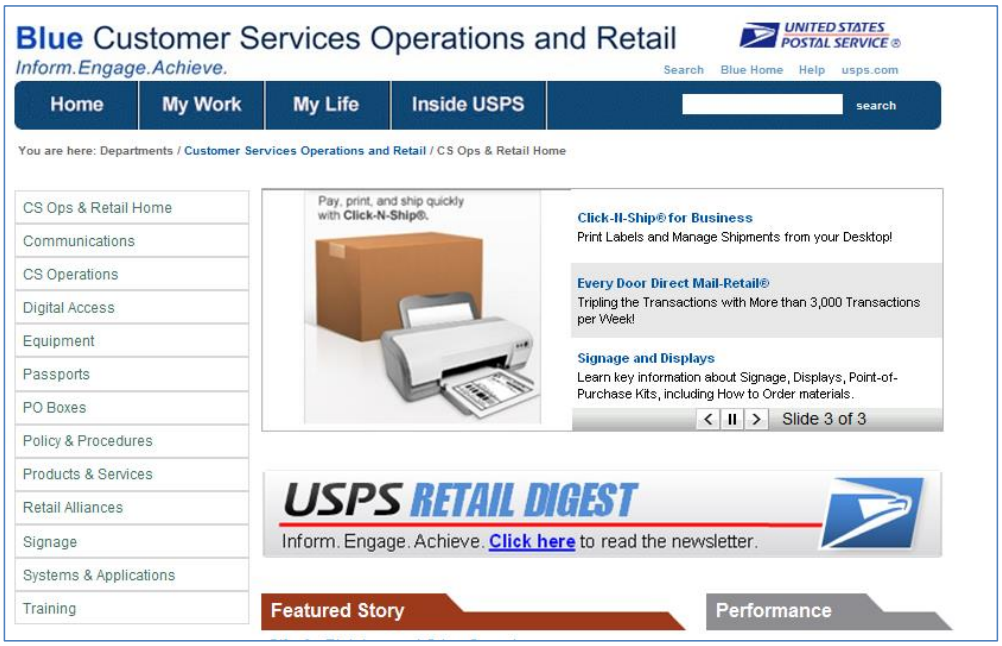
While it is important to know the information contained in your manuals, it is just as important to know where they can be found. I suggest you take a few moments to familiarize yourself with resources available on line. The Retail Website has a host of information that can help keep you informed and up to date on SOPs, Products and policies.

Here is how you access the Retail Website.

- Open the Blue page
- Click on the "Operations" section
- Click on the "Retail & Customer Services Operations~~Delivery and PO Ops~~" link
- ~~On the left hand side, click the Post Office Operations line (third item in the list~~

To access the Retail site directly use the following URL and then you can bookmark it for future reference.

http://blue.usps.gov/customerservicesoperationsandretail/home.shtml



From the Retail Digest page all other Retail related pages can be accessed via the menu on the left hand side of the page. There are links to Policy & Procedures, Signage, Products & Services, Communications, Retail Alliances, and even Training information.

The Retail Handbook PO-209 is the cornerstone to understanding the policies and procedures for day-to-day retail management, training, sales skills and other key information about retail operations.

A number of Postal manuals are available on the Blue page. The URL is http://blue.usps.gov/cpim/manuals.htm.

Additionally, the Postal Bulletin is available. The URL is http://about.usps.com/postal-bulletin/pb2013.htm.

Here is a listing where each manual can be found. You may also reference the Postal Bulletin, which provides any necessary updates to Postal directives.

Domestic Mail Manual (DMM) contains the official rates and standards of the US Postal Service governing domestic mail services.

International Mail Manual (IMM) sets forth the conditions and procedures for the preparation and treatment of mail being sent to other countries.

Administrative Support Manual (ASM) contains policies and procedures for the administrative support functions of the USPS.

Postal Operations Manual (POM) contains policies and procedures governing USPS operational functions.

Post Office Accounting Procedures (F-1) is the reference used for financial responsibilities and accounting procedures.

The Employee and Labor Relations Manual (ELM) contains the personnel policies and regulations governing USPS employment.

The Postal Bulletin is the first official notification of updates to permanent directives. Along with policies, procedures, and forms updates.

Also includes:

- Cover Story
- Organization information
- (Finance, HR, Labor Relations, Stamp Services)
- Pull-out information
- Fraud, Overseas military mail i.e., APO/FPO

Matching Exercise

Definition	Directive
1. This handbook provides direction and guidance for postmasters, managers, and supervisors with retail responsibility. The handbook is the cornerstone to understanding the policies and procedures for day-to-day retail management.	A. Retail Operations Handbook B. Domestic Mail Manual (DMM)
2. Revised and published periodically, it contains the official rates and standards of the US Postal Service governing domestic mail services.	
3. This contains the personnel policies and regulations governing USPS employment (e.g., uniform allowance information.)	C. International Mail Manual (IMM)
4. This manual sets forth the conditions and procedures for the preparation and treatment of mail being sent to other countries.	D. Administrative Support Manual (ASM)
5. This is the reference used for financial responsibilities and accounting procedures.	E. Postal Operations Manual (POM)
6. This contains policies and procedures for the administrative support functions of the USPS. Chapter 3 covers communication (Freedom of Information Act, Privacy Act, and Chart for Retention Dates).	F. Post Office Accounting Procedures (F-1)
7. The policies and procedures governing USPS operational functions are located here (e.g., distribution, P.O. boxes, Special Services).	G. Employee and Labor Relations Manual (ELM)
8. You are working at the window when a customer brings in spoiled or unused meter strips and demands a refund. You tell her that she is only	

eligible for a 90% refund. She becomes upset and asks you to show her where it says this in writing. Where can you find this information?

9. A customer presents an envelope to be mailed and asks that it be registered. The customer states that the envelope contains a check for $13,000 and wants it insured. The associate states that a check cannot be insured, even with registered mail for any more than the cost of issuing a replacement check. The customer argues and wants you to prove it.

10. You discover files in your office spanning the past seven years. You need to know what you can dispose of and what you need to retain.

Summary

As LSSAs, there are many components of leadership. Customers, peers, and supervisors rely on you in different ways. You have the opportunity to interact and influence people on a daily basis. As the last activity showed, most of what you do requires some type of leadership quality

Another important aspect of leadership involves being a valuable resource. Your familiarity with manuals and handbooks will not only help you with dealing with customers, it will also provide guidance to other members of your unit. Make sure all directives are available to your unit and keep them up to date. Being the "go to" resource will establish you as a leader among your peers.

In addition to the resources covered in this module, important information can be found through the Retail Digest, POS Helpdesk, along with websites such as Enterprise Data Warehouse (EDW), Retail Customer Experience Portal (RCE) and USPS.com

Module 3: Communication

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- State how communication impacts your ability to be effective in your role.
- Identify the three (3) components of communication: verbal (spoken word), non-verbal (body language), and listening.
- List tips for effective communication during conflict resolution.

Time Allocated for Module:

- 2 Hours

Instructional Methods:

- Presentation
- Activities
- Group Discussion

Summary:

- Impact of Communication
- Active Listening
- Conflict Resolution Tips

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- Rip Chart
- Module 3 PowerPoint presentation
- Projector for PowerPoint presentation

Impact of Communication

Now that we reviewed the LSSA position description and discussed leadership, on a scale of 1 to 10, with 1 being least important and 10 being most important, how important do you think communication is in your role as an LSSA?

What are some everyday situations you encounter as LSSAs?

The Three Levels of Communication

In listening to the examples you shared, we can categorize them into three communication channels the LSSAs have to manage: 1) customer communications, 2) peer communications, and 3) supervisory communications. Your ability to communicate impacts your effectiveness as an LSSA.

As mentioned before, communication is a vital part of your role as an LSSA. The ability to communicate effectively is the key to helping the unit be successful. Communication can also help improve the customer experience and meet revenue generation goals.

The way you communicated with each of these three groups as an SSA will change now that you are an LSSA since it is a lead role. Each group is unique in terms of the connection to the LSSA role. It is critical that you effectively communicate with all levels of the organization in order to effectively support your SSA and management.

LSSA to Supervisor:

What is the relationship? Bridge, Knowledge Resource

Method of communication – face to face, email, notes, phone

Expectations:

- Disseminate policy and sharing of goals
- Make sure the retail window runs smoothly
- Assists with scheduling
- Alert Supervisors to issues and provide solutions
- Assists with counts

LSSA to SSA:

What is the relationship? Coach/Mentor, Resource, Go-to person

Method of communication – face to face, service talks, communication folders

Expectations:

- Suggests options
- Lead by example
- Provide information
- Act as a resource
- Give service talks
- Share USPS policy and explain it
- Collaborate

LSSA to Customer:

What is the relationship? Knowledge Resource, Subject Matter Expert

Method of communication – face to face, phone, both sides of the counter

Expectations:

- Answering questions and concerns that other SSAs cannot resolve
- Being highly knowledgeable about products and services
- Projecting a positive and professional image of the USPS
- Problem solver
- Empathetic
- Speaking in terms customers can understand

Communication is a two sided process involving a speaker and a listener. Effective communication improves productivity, resolves conflicts, and builds relationships. As we know, communication isn't always so simple or straightforward. There are chains of communication and messages can get mixed up leaving the sender and the receiver confused and frustrated.

There are three parts to verbal communication: spoken words, body language, and listening. Another way to remember them is 1) what you say, 2) what you show, and 3) what you hear.

Your choice of words, tone, and volume can emphasize or de-emphasize key points when communicating policies and procedures, and giving service talks. As an LSSA you are often passing information between peers and supervisors, as well as from customers to peers and then back to supervisors. It is important that this information be communicated clearly and correctly. Therefore, be careful when choosing the right words, consider your tone of voice, and make sure that your volume is appropriate for the work environment.

Effective communication occurs when a desired outcome is the result of intentional information sharing, and you are then able to maintain that outcome moving forward.

You want to be aware of how you use spoken words when communicating with others.

How can you deliver a clear message to ensure that you are communicating effectively during the different situations you encounter in the workplace?

Did you know your body also communicates while you speak? If your words and actions don't match, you'll send mixed messages and confuse the listener. While there are certain aspects of body language that can be improved upon to create a more effective message, you still want to act like yourself and not be robotic.

Your posture, motions, eye contact, and even the look on your face sends a message when you are communicating. Think about your body language patterns. Make a conscious effort to think about what your body is doing while you are interacting with different people. Particularly pay attention to what your body does when confronted with uncomfortable situations.

Your body language (or what you show) is effective if it communicates the message you want it to communicate.

Some examples:

- You finish helping a customer in line and another customer quickly approaches before you get a chance to reset. How do you readjust your body language to help this customer?
- While helping a customer, you scan the lobby and see a repeat customer who is often difficult to serve. Has your body language changed and how do you react?

One of the most important factors of communication is listening. Hear what the person says, respect the importance of the person's message, and confirm what the person really means.

Since communication is a two sided process, listening may be the most important aspect for two reasons. First, it confirms that the other person's message is important to you, and second, it gives you the information you need to provide a proper response.

Active listening involves focusing not only on verbal communication skills, but also on body language cues, in order to get a thorough understanding of the speaker's message.

Focus on the message behind the words, just as much as the words themselves. Your goal is to understand what the speaker is trying to communicate to you, regardless of how effective the speaker is at articulating the message.

As an LSSA this is an extremely valuable skill since you have to listen to supervisors, customers, and peers. When working with customers in particular, avoid formulating a response while you are listening. Wait until the speaker is finished, it is okay to respond with a simple comment or question to show that you are paying attention.

Activity: Listening

You're assisting a customer or SSA with a situation, when you overhear an SSA having difficulty voiding a transaction. You find yourself dividing your listening skills between the person in front of you and what's going on around you. Perhaps you find yourself trying to prioritize which situation you should attend to. Depending on where you are on the situation in front of you, you may finish up. Sometimes, you may need to ask the customer/SSA to excuse you momentarily to assist the SSA with voiding the transaction, and then return to the customer to close out the transaction.

1. Does this sound like a typical situation?
2. Has this ever happened to you?
3. How would YOU navigate through it?

Here are some examples of similar situations:

- Supervisors asking questions
- Clerks asking for change
- Training a new Clerk

1. How do you respond to the person?
2. How do you let them know their issue was of concern to you?
3. How do you show you are listening to their issue?

Active Listening

Active listening begins with a willingness to listen closely. Not only do you need to be able to hear what the individual is saying, but you also need to be able to understand the intended message. Focus on the speaker, make eye contact, ask questions, and note the speaker's rate of speech and volume. Do not interrupt when someone is speaking.

As LSSAs, your days are very hectic which requires you to multitask and juggle multiple priorities, such as assisting supervisors and focusing on customer satisfaction. Overcoming listening barriers is a daily challenge, but if you focus on the person, listen with tact and courtesy, and explain the action you plan to take, you can succeed.

Activity: Levels of Communication Role Play

a) Did the LSSA serve as a knowledge resource or subject matter expert? If so, how? If not, why not?

b) How was the LSSA's body language? Did they demonstrate listening skills? If so, how?

c) Was the LSSA comfortable communicating with the customer? Did they speak in terms customers can understand? Did they provide solutions? If so, how? If not, why not?

d) Was the LSSA comfortable communicating with the SSA?

e) Was the LSSA comfortable communicating with the Supervisor? If so, how? If not, why not? Was there anything the LSSA could have done differently to strengthen the communication?

Hopefully you now see how important the role of the LSSA is as a knowledgeable resource, the ongoing face-to-face communication, while answering questions and providing solutions.

Conflict Resolution Tips

When presented with conflict, applying the verbal, non-verbal, and active listening skills discussed earlier can help you reach a resolution sooner. These tips can help you when you encounter issues with customers, peers, and supervisors.

Has anyone ever had to deal with a difficult customer or a frustrated co-worker? How did you resolve the situation?

Here are some additional tips.

- Use body language that sets the speaker at ease
- Maintain a comfortable personal space
- Make eye contact
- Do not interrupt
- Think about what the person is saying
- Confirm you are listening
- Acknowledge their thoughts or feelings
- Summarize their issue(s) in your own words
- Show genuine concern
- Provide a response or next steps
- Be honest in your response
- Choose your words carefully
- Explain what you will do next

Suggested Effective Conflict Resolution Techniques

Here are some other conflict resolution techniques that you can use while on the job.

1. **Listen, Then Speak Out** – there are at least two sides to every situation. Listening will help you understand the nature of the conflict, so that you can immediately start troubleshooting.
2. **Gather the Group or Involved Parties** – give all respective parties an opportunity to speak so you can hear both sides. This can also expedite a resolution that will satisfy the group or involved parties.
3. **Be Unbiased/Impartial - Never Take Sides** – remember you are in a leadership position and should not display any opinion that favors one person over another. Likewise, you should not be partial toward one person. Hear both sides, and then come up with a fair and reasonable answer.
4. **Promote Teamwork** - Provide encouragement and motivation to your coworkers. Praise your employees for successful projects that were the direct result of their collaboration. You want your coworkers to think about the importance of working as a team.
5. **Give Accolades/"Shout Outs"** - employees like to be recognized for their good deeds. The power of encouragement and motivation cannot be understated. Additionally, your coworkers will appreciate your positive feedback.

6. **Never Embarrass** - Do not belittle or embarrass an employee, even if they are unruly and disrespectful. Simply inform the employee that you would like to speak to them privately or inform them that this is not the appropriate time or place to discuss the issue. Always offer an alternative time and place.

Activity: Conflict Resolutions Role Play (Follow Up)

Summary

As an LSSA, communication is a vital part of everything you do in your role to support the unit. Effective communication improves productivity, builds relationships, and keeps the unit functioning together. Poor communication can lead to confusion and frustration.

So many people depend on the Lead Sales and Services Associate. Enhancing the leadership role of the LSSA means bridging communications and connections. The LSSA is the center point:

- Remember the three components of verbal communication
- You are a bridge between management and SSAs
- You are a mentor and resource among your peers
- You are an expert to your customers

Module 4: Unit Operations

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Identify types of accountable paper
- Manage stamp stock
- Establish a cash or stamp credit
- Perform Counts

Time Allocated for Module:

- 90 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion
- Activities

Summary:

- Accountable Paper
- Establishing Credits (Cash and Stamps)
- Perform Counts
- Unit Reserve

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- Rip Chart

For Further Information:

- Handbook F-101, Field Accounting Procedures is available on the Postal Service Intranet on the PolicyNet Web site at http://blue.usps.gov/cpim.
- POS ONE Procedures Guide, Subchapter 12.2 through 12.9, is also available for referencing instructions on conducting counts in the POS system.

- Stamp Fulfillment Services (SFS) Toolkit has SFS Web training information, job aids, PowerPoint videos, and more at http://blue.usps.gov/accounting/stampfulfillmentsys/sfstoolkit.htm
- Accounting Help Desk – 1-866-974-2733

  http://blue.usps.gov/wps/portal/accounting/accthelp/accthelpdesk

Accountable Paper

Accountability is key to the success of the United States Postal Service. Just as sales of special services have a positive impact on revenue generation, shortages have a negative impact. Your ability to stock and protect accountable paper enables the retail unit to be financially successful.

Overview

Accountable paper is defined as postage stock, stamped papers, non-postal stamps, philatelic products, and money order stock.

1. **Postage stock** is defined as postage stamps, semi-postal stamps.
2. **Stamped papers** are defined as stamped envelopes, International reply coupons (IRCs), and postal cards (includes regular, special, commemorative, and penalty mail issues).
3. **Non Postal Stamps** are migratory bird hunting and conservation stamps sold for the Department of the Interior.
4. **Philatelic Products** are defined as mint sets, stamp collecting kits, gift packs, and other products in Items 8000-9999 series (ex. stamp collecting books).
5. **Money Order Stock.**

Managing Stock

Now that we've covered the various types of accountable paper, let's discuss how to deal with stock in terms of ordering, returning, and even the destruction of stock when it is no longer used.

Ordering Stock

As an LSSA, you must have access to SFS Web for the purpose of ordering stock which has controls in place accountable paper.

Returning Stock

Saleable stock that may be returned to SFS or SDO which includes stamps, stamped envelopes, postal cards, and philatelic products currently on sale.

Note: The SFS or SDO must authorize the return of saleable stock before the stamp stock custodian returns it.

Destroying Stamp Stock

LSSAs are not allowed to destroy stamp stock, but there are policies in place that instruct you where to ship stock for destruction.

Field Units Policy on Destroying Stamp Stock

U.S.-issued and foreign-issued international reply coupons are never destroyed, but are redeemed. Postage Validation Imprinter (PVI) labels are never destroyed, but are refunded. Spoiled meter stamps are destroyed after verification and approval.

Stamp stock destruction includes counting, recording, and destroying non-saleable stamps, stamped paper, and philatelic products. Stamp destruction activities are conducted only at a designated SDO or SFS unless an alternate location has been approved by the OIG on a case-by-case basis.

For this item…	**Follow this procedure…**
Damaged stamps returned by customers	a. Do not count these stamps individually. b. Accept the credit value that is marked by the unit on the booklet or wrapper. c. If the value claimed by the unit seems excessive or unreasonable, notify the USPIS and OIG. d. For additional information on damaged stamps, see *Mailing Standards of the United States Postal Service*, Domestic Mail Manual (DMM®) 604.9.1.
Postal cards (The value is printed in the stamp area.)	Redeem at item value (amount item sells for) when returned unsold to the SFS from a unit reserve.
Picture postcards (Contain pictures printed on the entire front of the card. Postage value is printed on the back.)	Redeem at item value (amount item sells for) when returned unsold to the SFS from a unit reserve.
Postal stamped paper	Accept the value claimed, especially when returned by customers. (See DMM 604.9.0 for provisions for exchanging stamped paper.)
Plain stamped and nonprofit envelopes	Record the value of stamped envelopes at full value, including window envelopes. Clearly display the value claimed for each item on PS Form 17.

The SFS schedules all stamp return cycles, typically four times a year, two week time periods in designated weeks of the quarter to return stamps for destruction.

Protection of Funds and Stock

Security Requirements

The security requirements for protecting accountable paper and stamp credits are as follows:

During the duty day, accountable paper and stamp credits may be stored in a locked drawer or cabinet. At all other times, store accountable paper and stamp credits in the main vault, safe, or security container that affords the best available protection. (See Handbook F-101, Section 3-1.1.2.)

Keep high denominations in the safest place if storage facilities offer different levels of security.

Keep stamps in places inaccessible to the public and concealed from public view during business hours.

If a Postal Retail Unit (PRU) does not have appropriate security equipment, move stamps in excess of a week's supply to a more secure place. However, the postmaster or designee must have sole control over the stock.

Keep stamped envelopes and postal cards assigned to the unit reserve locked in receptacles or rooms accessible only to the unit reserve stock custodian.

Do not leave stamp stock in the open.

Place stamp credits (including retail floor stock) in a locked container and store in a vault, safe, or security container, following an employee's tour of duty.

Do not allow any employee, supervisor, or postmaster to have access to the stamp credit of another employee.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Stamp Requisition/Stamp Return

Location ID *(10-digit unit finance #)* of shipping unit	Name of Postal Retail Unit			Postmark
_ _ _ _ _ _ - _ _ _ _				
Telephone No.	City	State	5-Digit ZIP Code™	
Signature of Submitter	Required for all Stock Shipped or Returned			
	Location ID *(10-digit unit finance #)* of receiving unit _ _ _ _ _ _ - _ _ _ _			Date
Signature of Shipper	Registry Number Used		Shipment # *(10-digit)*	
Signature of Witness	**Stamp Requistion -** Prepare in duplicate. Submit ORIGINAL and keep a COPY at the unit. Print clearly all information. **Stamp Return to SDO/SSC -** Prepare four copies, ORIGINAL in an envelope taped to the outside of package, two COPIES inside, and keep a COPY at the unit. **Ship to Other Locations -** Prepare in duplicate, submit ORIGINAL inside of package to receiving unit, and keep a COPY at the unit. Use the location ID *(10-digit unit finance #)* of receiving unit.			

Type: *(Check One)* ☐ Scheduled Order ☐ Emergency Order ☐ Return Stock ☐ Return for Destruction ☐ Ship to Other Location

Do Not Substitute	Item No.	Quantity	Redemption Rate (Destruction)	Dollar Value	Denomination	Description
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
				Total Value	Signature of Person Receiving Stock	
				$	Signature of Witness	

Section to Be Completed by Stamp Destruction Committee

Method of Disposition	Value *(In words)* **(SDO/SSC USE ONLY CORRECTED VALUE)**

Certificate of Destruction Committee

We certify that the stock value (in words) was verified.

Member of Committee and Title

Member of Committee and Title

Member of Committee and Title

Postmark

Date

Each member witnessed the disposal of the stock by the method specified above.

Member of Committee and Title

Member of Committee and Title

Member of Committee and Title

Postmark

Date

PS Form **17,** May 2007 (PSN 7530-03-000-9112)

Items to be returned for destruction.

Item No.	Quantity	Redemption Rate	Description
104100	**200**	**.01**	**Left Blank Intentionally**
104500	**100**	**.26**	**Left Blank Intentionally**
470100	**100**	**.49**	**Left Blank Intentionally**
688500	**50**	**9.80**	**Left Blank Intentionally**

For more information on the items we just discussed see Job Aid 4A Ordering, Receiving, Issuing and Returning Stock. Since stamp stock has an impact on revenue generation, the protection of funds and stock is critical to the success of your unit.

Establishing Credits (Cash or Stamps)

LSSAs establish cash, stamp credits, and money orders to Sales and Services Associates (SSA). It is important that you are able to establish credits because the SSA is accountable for the cash they are given.

Cash Retained

SSAs that are only given a cash credit are authorized a cash retained amount of up to $100.99 for which they are individually accountable. The maximum authorized cash retained amount is documented on PS Form 3369, Consigned Credit Receipt.

Individual SSA cash retained amounts must be reported in AIC 753, Cash Retained Today, on the individual's PS Form 1412 and cannot exceed the approved amount.

Cash retained credits are considered inactive if there is no activity at least once each postal quarter for credits with funds or $0 balance reported in AIC 753. See Handbook F-101 part 13-7.6 for handling inactive cash retained credits.

To remove (terminate) an SSA in the POS system, see the POS ONE Procedures Guide, which is available on the POS ONE Program Office Website.

- **Go to http://eagnmnsxfb0/posone.**
- **Under "User Information," click Training.**
- **Click NCR POS ONE Training Links and Online Guides.**
- **Click NCR Procedures Guide (the most current version available).**

NOTE: Only an employee assigned a POS ONE Administrator role at the PRU can remove (terminate) a user (employee) from the POS system.

Requirements for Individual Stamp Credit Counts

As an LSSA you may be asked to randomly count stamp credits maintained by bargaining unit employees at least once every 4 months from the month of the last count. Stamp credits maintained by non-bargaining unit employees must be counted by the non-bargaining employee and another employee no less frequently than once every fiscal year (October–September).

Stamp Credits

A stamp credit is the value of the stamp stock and money orders consigned to a Sales and Services Associate (SSA) from the unit reserve stock at a postal retail unit.

Stamp credits are set for the SSA's using a two week sales amount as a guide. The postmaster, supervisor, or manager may adjust the value of stamp credits to be consistent with customer demand.

In order to maintain individual accountability, SSAs must not trade or purchase stamp stock from one another.

In an emergency, a supervisor may authorize an SSA to ship or receive stock from another SSA as follows:

- The supervisor or SSA completes a PS Form 17, *Stamp Requisition/Stamp Return*, in duplicate. Enter the names of both SSAs and the amount of stamp stock on PS Form 17.
- The supervisor must witness and sign PS Form 17 authorizing this transaction.

The SSA must keep a copy of the PS Form 17 until the next stamp credit count.

Along with establishing cash and stamp credits, LSSAs must also establish cash reserves for their unit and stamp credits for SSAs. These are part of the unit's financial accountability.

Establishing a Unit Cash Reserve

Postal Retail Units (PRUs) may establish a unit cash reserve to supplement the needs of the unit.

The unit cash reserve is based on the Cost Ascertainment Group (CAG) assigned to the PRU.

- PRUs have the ability to increase or decrease their unit cash reserve as long as it is within the authorized "maximum amount." Management should make adjustments when circumstances warrant.
- Use PS Form 3369, *Consigned Credit Receipt*, to assign the unit cash reserve to an employee who is directly accountable.
- When circumstances warrant, the unit cash reserve custodian may reassign all or part of the unit cash reserve using PS Form 3369.
- Any reassigned funds must be kept separate from other accountable credits assigned to the employee.

- The unit cash reserve must be reported in AIC 753 on the unit's PS Form 1412. When performing a count of the unit cash reserve, there is no authorized tolerance applied.

NOTE: CPUs and SDAs are not authorized to have a unit cash reserve.

Changes to Unit Cash Reserves

A PRU may increase the amount of the unit cash reserve by submitting a request to their District Finance Manager (DFM) to increase the amount of their unit cash reserve but must not exceed the cap amount for their CAG group.

To request an increase to the unit cash reserve, PRU supervisors must do the following:

- Complete FNCM Unit Finance Number Request with header information and the current and new requested amount for Authorized Unit Cash Reserve.
- Scan and submit the request via email to the District Finance Manager (DFM) for approval. The email must include "Request to Increase Unit Cash Reserve" in the subject line and justification for the request in the body of the email. File a copy locally of completed form and email request.
- Upon receipt of the request, the DFM does one of the following:
- Send an email to the unit with decision of approval and submit the completed FNCM form along with approval email to FNCM FSB to update the unit cash reserve amount in FNCM; or
- Send an email to the unit with decision of disapproval.
- For requests approved by the DFM, the PRU supervisor must do the following:
- Update PS Form 3369 to reflect the amount authorized by the DFM.
- Update the unit cash reserve amount as needed on PS Form 1412 (See 13-7.4)
- Maintain copies of email as supporting documentation.

NOTE: If the DFM determines that a unit cash amount, considering the requested increase, is excessive, he or she can disapprove the requested increase and determine the appropriate cash level.

Once every fiscal year, the DFM must review the amount of the unit cash reserve for those units that have been authorized as an exception to validate that the need still exists for the increased amount.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

Consigned Credit Receipt

Name	Location of Credit		
(Check One) ☐ Stamp Credit ☐ Cash Credit	Credit Amount		
	Maximum Authorized Cash		
Issued by (Signature)		Date	

I will faithfully account to the U.S. Postal Service for the consigned credit amount shown above or modified by transactions recorded on my Daily Financial Reports. I have read the following statements and have been advised of the priorities of protection to be given to funds and accountable paper in Chapter 3 of Handbook F-101, *Field Accounting Procedures*. Employees and contractors will be held responsible for losses of stamps and funds from stamp or cash credits resulting from failure to give the best available protection during and after business hours. Withdrawals of official funds for personal use, whether temporary or permanent, may subject employees or contractors to removal from office, cancellation of contract, and criminal prosecution

Signature	Date

PS Form **3369**, August 2010

Performing Counts

To establish a credit and perform a count using the correct procedures, refer to **Handbook F-101 *Field Accounting Procedures, Chapter 13, Stamp Stock and Cash Credits*.**

As you are aware, it is critical that you perform counts using the correct procedures because shortages directly affect postal revenue. One of the goals of the U.S. Postal Service is to decrease shortages.

As a Lead Sales and Services Associate, you can conduct cash counts as described in Handbook F-101 Chapter 13 Section 13.8 through 13.9, *Field Accounting Procedures* (October 2013).

PS Forms Used in Counts

There are multiple forms used when performing counts. Each form has a specific use based on the situation. The following table describes the forms used during random counts of an employee's stamp credit. We will go through the list before moving on to an actual count.

Use…	To record…
PS Form 3294 (Manual)	Used when performing a count of a cash and stamp stock credit including the count results. File locally with record of employee cash and/or stamp credit counts. Both the supervisor and the employee to whom the credit is assigned or the employee's representative must complete an independent PS Form 3294. (See part 3-8.3 for designated witness procedures.) Each completed form must be signed by both counters.
The system-generated PS Form 3294-C	Used when performing a count of a cash credit at an SIA unit, including the count results. File locally with record of employee cash and/or stamp credit counts.
PS Form 3368-P	Used to record accountability credit counts performed with the count results. File locally with record of employee cash and/or stamp credit counts. Note: Enter the last date for completion of the next examination as required by the National Agreement in the appropriate column.
PS Form 571	Form must be completed when there is a difference (overage/shortage) of $100 or more. It must be submitted to the Appropriate **Office of Inspector General (OIG)** and District Finance Manager. Unit keeps the file copy for their records.
PS Form 32934-SSK (formerly APC)	• System generated count sheets from the SSK are used to count the SSK accountability. Two independent counts are performed. When complete **attach the Count Sheets with APC variable rate postage attached and cancelled to PS Form 32943 that printed from the APC.** • **File system-generated PS Form 32943 and all supporting documentation in the APC audit folder.**

Prepare to Perform the Count

When preparing to perform a count select a quiet area away from the retail unit without any distractions and allow sufficient space to work.

Collect the necessary materials needed to perform the count (two copies of PS Form 3294, an operable calculator, and at least two pencils).

Conduct the Count

Announce the count and stay with the employee during the entire duration of the count.

NOTE: Independent counts must be done by the examiner and employee—using separate count sheets.

Correct Procedures that Follow the Count

Counts with an overage or shortage of more than $10.00: If the difference amount exceeds tolerance and the parties involved cannot agree to the count, recount the credit at the request of the employee. After you have established the difference amount, bring the accountability into balance.

Tolerance Table

The following table specifies the tolerance that PRU employees must use for counts:

Amount of Cash Credit	
Up to $100.99	**$10.00**

There are many other counts that you may have to perform as an LSSA. Examples of such counts include unit reserve, unit cash reserve, cash retained credits, individual stamp credits, and retail floor stock, to name a few. We will review these to give you an idea of the various counts.

Conducting Cash Counts

Contract Postal Unit Stamp Credit Count

The postmaster, manager, or supervisor of the host Post Office has the following responsibilities:

- Ensuring that CPU stamp credit counts are conducted randomly at least once a fiscal year (see Count and Tolerance tables in 13-9).
- Maintaining a separate file for CPU financial activities.

Cash Retained Credit Counts (POS Units Only)

Each employee working from the retail floor stock under segmented inventory accountability has a cash retained credit. Cash retained credits must be counted randomly at least once each postal quarter. Counts can be conducted any day within the postal quarter, but should be conducted randomly to avoid establishing a pattern. This includes bargaining and non-bargaining employees and postmaster reliefs.

Cash retained credit counts must be conducted using the POS workflow. Each employee's domestic and international (MP-1) money orders must be counted in conjunction with the cash credit count. (See the *POS ONE Procedures Guide*, subchapter 12-5, for instructions on conducting counts in the POS system.)

If an employee has a reassigned portion of the unit cash reserve, it must be counted in conjunction with the cash retained credit count. The assigned employee and another employee, one of whom must be a non-bargaining employee, perform the count(s).

NOTE: If a non-bargaining employee is not domiciled at the unit, the postmaster, manager, or supervisor responsible for the unit is required to perform an independent cash credit count no less than once every postal quarter.

Cash Retained Count Tolerance

Each employee is authorized a tolerance of $10 during his or her cash retained credit count regardless of the amount of the cash retained credit.

No tolerance is applied when conducting a final count of a cash retained credit. A final count of a cash retained credit must be conducted if any of the following conditions apply:

- The accountable role is being removed from the SSA in the POS system due to nonuse or inactivity.
- The SSA is separated from the Postal Service.
- The SSA bids to another position that does not require use of the POS system.
- The SSA's cash retained balance (AIC 753) is reduced to zero (a zero balance in AIC 753 allows the role to remain open for up to 4 months without activity).

Unit Cash Reserve Counts

The unit cash reserve that is assigned to an employee must be counted randomly at least once each postal quarter. If an employee also has a cash retained credit, the unit cash reserve must be counted in conjunction with the cash retained count.

- Any portions of the unit cash reserve reassigned to bargaining employees must be counted at least once each postal quarter in conjunction with the cash retained count.
- The count is performed by the assignee and a witness, one of whom must be a non-bargaining employee (see the note in part 13-8.3).
- If the unit cash reserve custodian is reassigned, a count must be performed and a new PS Form 3369 is completed for the replacement cash reserve custodian.

Unit Reserve Stamp Stock Credit Count

The count of the unit reserve stamp stock credit is the same as a stamp credit count for an employee (see subchapter 13-3) with these exceptions:

- If the unit reserve stock custodian has a retail floor stock role (POS units only), the unit reserve stamp stock credit must be counted concurrently with the retail floor stock (before any unit reserve transactions take place).
- If the result of the retail floor stock count (POS units only) exceeds the inventory variance of 0.1 percent since the last count, a count of the unit reserve stamp stock credit must also be completed concurrently (before any unit reserve transactions take place).
- Unit reserve stock must not contain any cash.
- Ensure the unit reserve stock inventory report matches the unit reserve total on the clerk balance list or the manual accountability re-cap form.
- For non-POS units, obtain the closing balance from the last system-generated or manual (eMOVES units) PS Form 3959, and record to Stamp Stock per PS Form 3959 under Unit Reserve Stamp Stock Count Summary on PS Form 3294.
- After the count is performed:

Unit Reserve Stamp Stock Management

Unit reserve is the main stock of postal products that come from Stamp Fulfillment Services (SFS). It is counted once a fiscal year.

The unit reserve stock custodian is accountable for the value of all items in the unit reserve stock, is responsible for managing the stamp stock inventory, and must report unit reserve stock activities. Sales from the unit reserve stock are not allowed. The unit reserve may be assigned to the postmaster, unit manager, or supervisor. At a finance station without a domiciled supervisor, a Lead Sales and Services Associate (LSSA) may be assigned to unit reserve. The LSSA may also be assigned a separate stamp and/or cash credit from which direct sales to the public are conducted.

The unit reserve stock custodian maintains and secures all accountable papers for the unit in compliance with the levels authorized for the various stamp credits or segments. The unit reserve stock custodian issues stamp stock directly to Sales and Service Associate who are assigned stamp credits.

Units that use this reporting tool…	**Report unit reserve stamp stock credit counts as follows…**
POS	Unit reserve stock custodian must post the count in the POS system and the other employee conducting the count will review and acknowledge the count. The POS system will auto-post overages and shortages and adjust inventory to amount as counted. Overages or shortages exceeding the tolerance will post to the Unresolved Employee Items report. Print the system-generated PS Form 3958 and inventory list and ensure totals match.

The postmaster, manager, or supervisor is responsible for ensuring that the required Self Service Kiosk-(SSK) stamp stock count is performed randomly at least once every postal quarter.

Prior to conducting the count, the closing balance (AIC 853) on the SSK's PS Form 1412 must be verified against the Stamp Stock Ledger balance in the ADM, for the most recent data available. Units that cannot access the ADM can obtain this information by calling the AHD at 866-974-2733.

Complete instructions for conducting SSK counts are available on the SSK, formerly APC, web site.

1. Go to http://blue.usps.gov.
2. Click the Inside USPS tab.
3. Under "Headquarters, Finance," click the Accounting link.
4. Under "Related Links," click the Automated Postal Center (APC) link.
5. Under "Operational Procedures," click the Finance Issues link.

The direct URL is http://eagnmnsxfb0/APC/procs/procs.asp.

Unit Cash Reserve

Is assigned to an employee and must be counted randomly at least once each postal quarter. If an employee also has a cash retained credit, the unit cash reserve must be counted in conjunction with the cash retained count.

We are now going to perform a manual cash count using PS Form 3294. Take a few minutes to complete the worksheet on the bottom right section and use that information to complete the Unit Cash Reserve Count section of this form. The list of items located in your drawer is below and on the projector.

You also have two international money orders, 77 domestic money orders in sequence, and 3 bait money orders in good condition.

Denomination	Quantity
$100.00	
$ 50.00	
$20.00	2
$10.00	1
$5.00	6
$2.00	
$1.00	11
$0.50	
$0.25	15
$0.10	26
$0.05	18
$0.01	30

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Cash and Stamp Stock Count and Summary

Type of Accountability ☐ Unit Reserve Stamp Stock ☐ Unit Cash Reserve ☐ Stamp Stock Credit

Name of Employee	Clerk ID No.	Unit Name	Unit ID No.	Date of Examination

Unit Reserve Stamp Stock Count Summary

Stamp Stock per PS Form 3958		☐ AIC 057, Employee Stock Credit Overage ☐ AIC 767, Employee Stock Credit Shortage ☐ PS Form 571, *Discrepancy of $100 or More in Financial Responsibility* ☐ PS Form 3368, *Stamp Credit Examination Record*
Stamp Stock on Hand per Count		
Difference ☐ Over ☐ Short		

Unit Cash Reserve Count Summary

Unit Cash per AIC 753		☐ AIC 068, Employee Cash Credit Overage ☐ AIC 764, Employee Cash Credit Shortage ☐ PS Form 571, *Discrepancy of $100 or More in Financial Responsibility* ☐ PS Form 3368, *Stamp Credit Examination Record*
Cash on Hand per Count (from worksheet)		
Difference ☐ Over ☐ Short		

Cash/Stamp Stock Credit Count Summary

Summary of Accountability

		Action Taken
1. Total Cash as counted (from worksheet)	$	☐ Within Tolerance ☐ AIC 057, Employee Stock Credit Overage ☐ AIC 767, Employee Stock Credit Shortage ☐ PS Form 571, *Discrepancy of $100 or More in Financial Responsibility* ☐ PS Form 3368, *Stamp Credit Examination Record*
2. Total Stamp Stock as counted (page 2)	$	
3. Grand Total Cash and Stamp Stock as Counted (Line 1 + Line 2)	$	
4. Stamp Credit as reported in AIC 853 (from last PS Form 1412)	$	
5. Difference (Line 4 - Line 3)	$	

Verification of Money Orders

Domestic	Are they issued in sequence?	☐ Yes	☐ No
Bait	Are they in good condition?	☐ Yes	☐ No
International	Are they issued in sequence?	☐ Yes	☐ No
Last Issued Domestic MO	MO Serial number:		
Last Issued International	MO Serial number:		

Money Orders on Hand: (List block numbers of all money orders)

Notes, etc.:

Worksheet for Unit Cash Reserve Count or Cash/Stamp Stock Credit Count

Denomination	Quantity	Amount
$ 100.00		$
$ 50.00		$
$ 20.00		$
$ 10.00		$
$ 5.00		$
$ 2.00		$
$ 1.00		$
$ 0.50		$
$ 0.25		$
$ 0.10		$
$ 0.05		$
$ 0.01		$
Total Cash		$

I have examined this stamp credit:

(Print Name of Supervisor)

(Signature of Supervisor) *(Postmark)*

I agree to the count:

(Print Name of Employee)

(Signature of Employee) *(Postmark)*

REMINDER: Is the Semi-Annual Examination of PS Form 3977 or the Annual Examination of Keys and Locks due? Use PS Form 3902, *Form 3977 Log and Lock Examination*, to maintain a record of the examinations.

Job Aid 4B Perform Counts is a resource you can use to review how to establish credits, perform counts, the types of counts, and general guidelines. It summarizes the content we just covered and is provided for you to take back to the field

Retail Floor Stock

Most units now have Retail Floor Stock. Only smaller units have individual stamp credits for SSAs. Since the majority of LSSAs are in a larger unit this is covered separately.

Smaller units will have individual stamp credits for SSAs but retail floor stock is different because it refers to the stamp stock, not cash, and replaces individual stamp credits. Most units will have retail floor stock.

Under the retail floor stock SIA concept, cash is separated from stamp stock in retail credits and a shared retail floor stock replaces individual stamp credits for Sales and Services Associates.

Retail Floor Stock count must be conducted at least once every postal quarter (October 1, January 1, April 1, and July 1). The goal in operating a retail floor stock is to maintain a threshold of within 0.1 percent variance over or short of total SIA sales since last count. This is stock that is transferred from the unit reserve to the retail floor to sell and is kept in a common place for all SSAs to work from.

A shared retail floor stock replaces individual stamp credits for SSAs.

The following table specifies the tolerance that PRU employees must use for counts:

The following is a snapshot of the Segmented Inventory Accountability (SIA) Chart for your reference. This chart provides the tolerance for each count, frequency, and where overages/shortages are recorded. Please take a minute to review the chart.

Segmented Inventory Accountability Chart

For this accountability credit…	The tolerance is…	Count this credit every…	Record overages in…	Record shortages in…
Unit Reserve Stock				
Bargaining Employee	See part 13-9.2	4 months*	AIC 057	AIC 767
Nonbargaining Employee		once a fiscal year*	AIC 057	AIC 767
PMR		once a fiscal year*	AIC 057	AIC 767
Unit Cash Reserve				
Bargaining Employee	$0.00	once a postal quarter*	AIC 068	AIC 764
Nonbargaining Employee	$0.00	once a postal quarter*	AIC 068	AIC 764
PMR	$0.00	once a postal quarter*	AIC 068	AIC 764
SIA Cash Credit (Cash Retained)				
Bargaining Employee	$10.00	once a postal quarter*	AIC 068	AIC 764
Nonbargaining Employee	$10.00	once a fiscal year*	AIC 068	AIC 764
PMR	$10.00	once a fiscal year*	AIC 068	AIC 764
Stamp Stock Credit				
Bargaining Employee	See part 13-9.2	4 months*	AIC 057	AIC 767
Nonbargaining Employee		once a fiscal year*	AIC 057	AIC 767
PMR		once a fiscal year*	AIC 057	AIC 767
SIA Retail Floor Stock				
Difference is = or < .1% of sales	$0.00	fiscal quarter	AIC 239	AIC 639
Difference > .1% of sales	$0.00	fiscal quarter; must also count unit reserve stock.	AIC 239	AIC 639
Self Service Kiosk				
Bargaining Employee	$0.00	3 months*	AIC 175	AIC 612
Nonbargaining Employee	$0.00	3 months*	AIC 175	AIC 612

PMR	$0.00	3 months*	AIC 175	AIC 612
Contract Postal Unit	$0.00	once a fiscal year*	AIC 057	AIC 767

** Counts must be conducted randomly within the minimum established frequency.*

Count Frequency	**Description**
At least once each postal quarter	Counts must be conducted any day within each postal quarter. PQ1: October–December PQ2: January–March PQ3: April–June PQ4: July–September
At least once every 4 months	Counts must be conducted no less frequently than once every 4 months from the month of the last count. A count performed on January 2nd is scheduled to be counted again, at the latest, any day within the month of May. Jan 2nd: Month of January, therefore latest due month is May
Once a fiscal year	Counts must be conducted randomly and no less frequently than once every fiscal year (October–September).

1. What is the tolerance for Cash Retained Counts?

2. What is the tolerance for Unit Cash Reserve?

3. How often do you count cash retained and unit cash reserve?

4a. What AICs do you record count results in (i.e., overages or shortages) for Unit Reserve Stock,

4b. What AICs do you record count results in for Unit Cash Reserve?

4c. What AICs do you record count results in for Cash Retained Credits (Segments)?

5. What PS Forms do you record the counts and the results of the count on?

Record Keeping

All records of counts must be kept for a designated time period. It is important to know how long specific records are kept for accountability purposes.

Retention periods for accounting/unit support documentation are listed in the Electronic Records and Information Management System (eRIMS) and must be strictly followed by field units. (Handbook F1, Accounting and Reporting Policy, Chapter 2, General Policies, Section 2-4.1.14.1).

Website: https://erims.usps.gov

USPS Form Retention Periods:

Form	Retention period
PS Form 3294, *Cash and Stamp Count Summary*	2 years, plus current fiscal year.
PS Form 3368-P (POS) *Accountability Examination Record*	2 years plus current fiscal year.
PS Form 3369, *Consigned Credit Receipt*	2 years plus current fiscal year.

Unit Reserve and the Postal Bulletin

Job Aid 4C Unit Reserve and the Postal Bulletin have information specific to Unit Reserves and information about the Postal Bulletin. It is provided for your review and to take with you back to the field.

Unit Information and Tools

POS One Message Board

When a SSA logs into the POS system, the message board provides alerts and updates regarding U. S. Postal Service domestic and international products and services.

USPS Retail provides guidance to functional offices and decides the placement of information based on pre-established editorial calendars that are designed to strategically communicate to the field retail organization the right information at the right time. USPS Retail reserves the right to specify alternate communications channels for disseminating information intended for the field retail organization.

PS Forms

PS Forms can help you in your retail unit. Below are a few forms that should be kept handy for your reference.

DS-11	Application for a U.S. Passport (422.23, 422.27, 422.292)
DS-82	U.S. Passport Renewal Application for Eligible Individuals *(Customer completes in person w/proper documents, LSSA confirms, and customer mails)*
PS Form 1412	Daily Financial Report (422.273, 422.28) *Prints out at the end of the day via POS—need to review the hardcopy for awareness.*
PS Form 3533	Application for Refund of Fees, Product and Withdrawal of Customer Accounts
PS Form 3546	Forwarding Order Change Notice (274.5)
PS Form 3575	Change-of-Address Order (461.321, 461.322)
PS Form 6401	Money Order Inquiry *(Customer completes/SSA enters in POS and submits)*
PS Form 673	Report of Rifled Parcel
PS Form 8105–A	Funds Transaction/Transfer Report (FTF) (Jan. 2010) (225, 229.122, 229.123, 229.13)
PS Form 8105–B	Suspicious Transaction Report (STR) (Jan. 2010) (225, 229.122, 229.123, 229.13)

Claims

Domestic Claims

All customers should be encouraged to file their domestic claims for loss or damage online on www.usps.com. If the customer does not have the ability to file a domestic claim online, they can file a Domestic claim by mail. They should call 1-800-ASK-USPS to have a domestic claim form mailed to them. Claims should not be processed or adjudicated locally. Nor, should any insurance fees be refunded.

Note: Remind customers to keep their documents as part of the claims process. Don't throw the contents away.

Accounting Services will notify the customer by mail if they are required to present the damaged item and packaging to a Postal Retail Unit for verification.

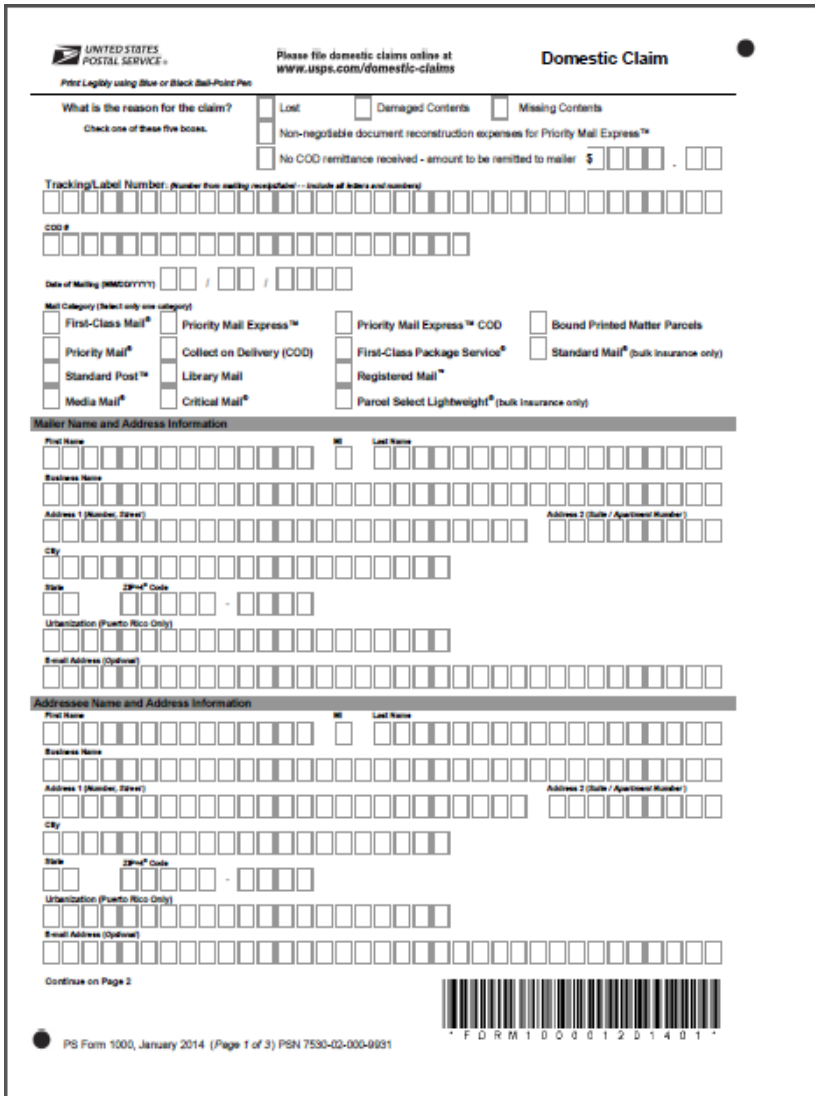
Two common scenarios involving PS Form 1000 for Domestic Claims:

1. The customer files their domestic claim online and all goes well, they are satisfied.
2. A customer comes into the post office to file a domestic claim. You refer them to the 800 number and the customer calls the 800 number and was mailed the domestic claim form; however, they demand your help. What do you do?
    a. Walk the customer through the instructions on the top of the domestic claim form which refers them to mail the form back to the St. Louis address:

        USPS Domestic Claims

        PO Box 80143

        St. Louis, MO 63180-0143



UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Please file domestic claims online at www.usps.com/domestic-claims

Domestic Claim

Print Legibly using Blue or Black Ball-Point Pen

What is the reason for the claim?
Check one of these five boxes.

- Lost
- Damaged Contents
- Missing Contents
- Non-negotiable document reconstruction expenses for Priority Mail Express™
- No COD remittance received - amount to be remitted to mailer $.

Tracking/Label Number: (Number from mailing receipt/label - include all letters and numbers)

COD #

Date of Mailing (MM/DD/YYYY) / /

Mail Category (Select only one category)

- First-Class Mail®
- Priority Mail®
- Standard Post™
- Media Mail®
- Priority Mail Express™
- Collect on Delivery (COD)
- Library Mail
- Critical Mail®
- Priority Mail Express™ COD
- First-Class Package Service®
- Registered Mail™
- Parcel Select Lightweight® (bulk insurance only)
- Bound Printed Matter Parcels
- Standard Mail® (bulk insurance only)

Mailer Name and Address Information

First Name | MI | Last Name

Business Name

Address 1 (Number, Street) | Address 2 (Suite / Apartment Number)

City

State | ZIP+4® Code

Urbanization (Puerto Rico Only)

E-mail Address (Optional)

Addressee Name and Address Information

First Name | MI | Last Name

Business Name

Address 1 (Number, Street) | Address 2 (Suite / Apartment Number)

City

State | ZIP+4® Code

Urbanization (Puerto Rico Only)

E-mail Address (Optional)

Continue on Page 2

* F D R M 1 0 0 0 0 1 2 0 1 4 0 1 *

PS Form 1000, January 2014 (Page 1 of 3) PSN 7530-02-000-9931

Please file domestic claims online at *www.usps.com/domestic-claims.* If you are unable to file online, you may submit this form to the following address:

USPS Domestic Claims

PO Box 80143

St. Louis, MO 63180-0143

Please retain copies of all documents mailed to St. Louis.

New Filing Timeframes for Domestic Claims (effective Jan. 26, 2014)

Customers presenting damaged items to support their claim must retain the mailing container, including wrapping, packaging, and any contents that were received, and upon written request, make them available to the local Post Office™ for inspection, retention, and disposition in accordance with the claims decision.

Evidence of Insurance – remind customers that it is important to keep their mailing transaction receipt.

Damaged or Missing Contents	Domestic Services		
	You should file all claims for **damaged or missing contents immediately**, but you must file no later than 60 days from the date of mailing.		
Lost Articles	Types of Service	When to File (from mailing date)	
		No Sooner Than	No Later Than
	Domestic Services		
	Insured Mail, includes Priority Mail®	15 days	60 days
	COD	15 days	60 days
	Registered Mail™	15 days	60 days
	Registered Mail™ COD	15 days	60 days
	Priority Mail Express™	7 days	60 days
	Priority Mail Express™ COD	15 days	60 days
	APO/FPO Priority Mail Express™ Military Service	21 days	90 days
	APO/FPO Insured First-Class Mail® space available (SAM), or parcel airlift (PAL)	45 days	1 year
	APO/FPO Insured (Surface Mail)	75 days	1 year

Processing a Damaged Item

Steps:

1. Did the customer already file a claim for this item? Does the customer have the letter from Accounting Services requesting that they bring the damaged item, packaging and mailing container to the Post Office? If the customer has not yet filed their claim – the postal employee needs to notify the customer to file their claim online.
2. Postal employee must complete PS 3831 *Receipt for Article(s) Damaged in the Mail* – give a copy to the customer, the other copy stays with the article at the Post Office.
3. Postal employee must verify the damage and complete PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents*.

   Important Note: Do not conduct in the presence of the customer.

4. Postal Employee should submit the completed PS Form 2856, a copy of the letter from Accounting Services, and any other relevant claim paperwork to St. Louis via mail (address is on the form). This needs to be mailed to St. Louis daily.

PS Form 3831, Receipt for Articles(s) Damaged in Mails

This receipt is an acknowledgement that you have accepted the items in connection with a claim for indemnity. Provide a copy of PS Form 3831 to the customer. The damaged article and packaging are retained by the Postal Service until the claim process is complete.



U.S. Postal Service
RECEIPT FOR ARTICLE(S) DAMAGED IN MAILS

Date: 12-17-09

Receipt is acknowledged of the following article(s) submitted in connection with a claim for indemnity for damage to the parcel described.

Received From: James Smith

Registered, Insured, COD, or Express Mail No.: 0180521390718445953?

Date Mailed: 12-01-09

Addressed To *(Name and address)*:
James Smith
100 mail ST
Culver City, CA 98765

Mailed At: Santa monica po

Mailed By: Damon Cleckler

Article(s) Received: Package with broken tea cup.

Signature and Title: [signature] Jones, SSA

Post Office, State and ZIP Code: Culver City, CA 98765

PS Form **3831**, June 1986 *(Duplicate to be attached to article(s))*

You must also complete PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents*. This form is for internal use only. This form should not be completed in the presence of the customer.

PS Form 2856, along with supporting documentation, are mailed daily to Accounting Services. Claims cannot be adjudicated at PRUs, they MUST BE handled by the Accounting Service Center.



UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents

FOR USPS USE ONLY

1. Customer Name: James Smith
2. Mailing Receipt/Article #: 062800005004356
3. Mailing Container Type/Brand: [X] Box [ ] Padded Envelope [ ] Tube [ ] Flat [ ] USPS® Packaging (Express Mail® / Priority Mail®) [ ] Ready Post® Packaging [ ] Other (Please describe) _____
4. Mailing Container Construction: [X] Sturdy [ ] Medium [ ] Flimsy
5. Damage to Mailing Container (Check all that apply): [ ] No Visible Damage [ ] Cut, Torn, or Ripped [ ] Liquid Damage [X] Crushed or Smashed [ ] Soiled or Stained [ ] Depression on Box [ ] Other (Please describe) _____
6. Packing Materials (Check all that apply): [ ] No Packing Material Submitted [X] Bubble Wrap [ ] Styrofoam Peanuts [ ] Double-boxes [ ] Newspaper [ ] Foam [ ] Tissue [ ] Other (Please describe)
7. Was container/packing material sufficient to protect contents from damage during normal handling? [X] Yes [ ] No [ ] Not Sure
8. What appears to have been the cause of the damage? (Check all that apply and write your comments in the space provided below.) [X] Fragility of Contents [ ] Crushing [ ] Shock [ ] Inadequate Packaging [ ] Leakage of Contents [ ] Perishable Contents [ ] Other (Please describe) _____
Comments: _____
9. List undamaged items included in the package.
10. If there is no visible damage to the article(s), what is customer's evidence of damage?
11. Location of Damaged Articles: POST OFFICE™ [ ] CUSTOMER [X] City: Culver City State: CA ZIP+4: 98765-9998 Telephone No. (include area code): (213)555-1234
Reason (check one): [ ] Under $25.00 [ ] For Repairs [ ] Claim Denied
Disposition of Articles: [X] MRC - Date sent: 12-17-09 (Claim paid - value $25.00 and over) [ ] Returned to Customer
[ ] Discarded - Date _____ (Claim paid - value under $25.00 or Hazardous) Return Date _____
12. **Reminder: Did you prepare a PS Form 3831, *Receipt for Article(s) Damaged in Mails*? If not, prepare one and mail it to the customer.**
13. Additional Comments:
14. Verified by: (Print Name): AL Jones Signature: Al Jones Telephone No. (include area code): (202)555-1234 ZIP Code™: 20260

When submitting claims, attach to PS Form 1000, Damage Inspection Request Letter, or Online Claim Summary and send to:

Domestic:
CLAIMS SERVICING SECTION
ACCOUNTING SERVICES
PO BOX 80143
ST LOUIS MO 63180-0143

International:
CLAIMS SERVICING SECTION
ACCOUNTING SERVICES
PO BOX 80146
ST LOUIS MO 63180-0146

Round Date Stamp

PS Form **2856**, March 2009 PSN 7530-09-000-3988

When customers present their damaged article to you for verification, you must complete the following steps:

- Ensure the Customer filed a claim for the item
- Complete PS 3831 Receipt for Article(s) Damaged
- Postal employee must verify damage item(s)
- Postal employee must submit PS 2856 claim to St. Louis via mail

*** Note: This is NOT to be filled out in front of the customer.

International Claims

The process for filing an international claim begins with an inquiry. The U.S. sender must initiate an inquiry before filing a claim for an article that he/she mailed to a foreign country and that has been lost (that has not been delivered) or was delivered with damaged and/or missing contents. Customers must allow sufficient delivery time in the foreign country before initiating an inquiry on a missing item. An inquiry for a Priority Mail Express International article can be filed no sooner than 3 days from the date of mailing or the guaranteed/scheduled delivery date and must be filed no later than 90 days from the date of mailing. PMEI w/Money Back Guarantee, can be filed no sooner than 3 days from the date of mailing or the guaranteed delivery date and no later than 30 days to submit an inquiry for delayed delivery and 90 days to submit inquiry for the loss, damage, or missing contents of an item.

Customers may file International Claims for Global Express Guaranteed (GXG), Priority Mail Express International, and Priority Mail Express International with Guarantee Service, Priority Mail International (insured and ordinary parcels) and Registered Mail.

Claims may not be filed for First-Class International items, First-Class Package International Service items, Priority Mail International Flat Rate Envelopes, Priority Mail International Small Rate Priced boxes or M-bag items. Inquiries for damaged and/or missing contents should be filed as soon as possible, but no more than 90 days after the mailing date. Subsequent claims may not be filed until the inquiry has been completed.

If a customer is requesting a postage refund for a Priority Mail Express International article with date certain delivery or guaranteed delivery, they have 30 days from the mailing date to initiate an inquiry in order to receive a postage refund for service delays.

To report the loss, damage and/or missing contents of an article sent to a foreign country, customers must call the Customer Care Center (CCC) at 800-222-1811.

They will need to provide IIC CCC with relevant information about the article that includes, but is not limited to, the item number appearing on the barcode, the name, address, and telephone number of the mailer, the name, address, and telephone number of the addressee, a description of the contents of the article, and the date the article was mailed.

Upon completion of an investigation and the CCC verifies that an item is lost, damaged and/or missing contents, a claim packet will be sent to the customer. Upon receipt of the claims packet, customers have 30 days to complete and submit the PS Form 2855, *International Claim for Indemnity*. Indemnity Claims should not be processed locally.

Damaged and/or Missing Contents

Customers, who receive an item from a foreign country in damaged condition or with missing content, must take the package (including the container and wrapping/packaging) immediately to the local Post Office for inspection, retention, and disposition in accordance with the claims decision. The Local Post Office should complete a PS Form 2856, Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents. This form or a copy of the form should not be provided to the customer. The form should be mailed to the designated address listed on the form.

To obtain the status or information regarding a filed claim, both customers and Postal Service employees may contact the Accounting Help Desk (AHD) at 866-974-2733.

Appeal an International Claims Decision

When International Indemnity insurance claims are denied, customers may appeal the decision by filing a written appeal and submitting it to Accounting Services. Customers have 60 days from the date of the original decision to file the appeal.

The appeal must focus on the basis of the claim denial. Customers will be notified in writing for any denied International Claims. The process for filing an appeal for a denied International Claim will be included in the notification letter. Customers have 60 days to file an appeal for international claims.

Refunds

Most of the 700 million pieces of mail we handle every year arrive safely, but when things don't go as planned we want to get any issues resolved quickly. We will describe the requirements, responsibilities, and procedures for reporting and documenting refund and exchange activities.

Refunds - Domestic Claims

PS Form 3533, Application for Refund of Fees, Products and Withdrawal of Customer Accounts, is used to document all refund activities.

a. The customer completes Part 1, Application, of PS Form 3533 and submits to the postal retail unit (PRU) for processing.

b. The LSSA reviews the PS Form 3533 and checks the appropriate box in the Request Disbursement For section.

c. The LSSA completes Part 2, Verification of Disbursements, of PS Form 3533 prior to issuing the refund locally or submitting the PS Form 3533 to the Scanning and Imaging Center (SIC) for processing the refund payment.

d. A witness to the refund transaction signs the Witness Signature line in Part 2. It is at the discretion of the postmaster or unit manager to determine if a postal employee is available to witness the refund transaction. It is the responsibility of the postmaster or unit manager to review PS Form 3533 to ensure the refund is warranted and that PS Form 3533 is completed properly.

   Note: PRUs do not locally issue refunds for more than $500 except when refunding Sure Money principal and fee amounts.

Refunds for $500 or Less

To issue a refund for $500 or less, the LSSA does the following:

a. Ensures Part 1 and Part 2 of PS Form 3533 is completed as detailed in subchapter 21-1, Overview.

b. If the refund is paid in cash (limited to $25), instructs the payee to sign and date Part 5, Disbursements for Refunds, of PS Form 3533.

c. If the refund amount is greater than $25, issues a no-fee money order to the customer and records the money order serial number and date issued in Part 5 of PS Form 3533.

d. Enters the amount of the refund in the appropriate refund AIC on PS Form 1412, Daily Financial Report. (Follow the guidelines on PS Form 3533 in the Request Disbursement For section.)

e. If a no-fee money order is issued, ensures the fee amount is reported in AIC 586. (POS and eMOVES units see F-101 (21-1.1) Appendix C, Exhibit C-4 for the list of Reason Codes to use for AIC 586.)

f. Submits the completed PS Form 3533 to the closeout employee as supporting documentation for PS Form 1412.

Note: PRUs do not locally refund balances from customer trust accounts, regardless of the amount.

Refunds for More Than $500

Refunds for more than $500 are issued by Accounting Services. To process a refund for more than $500, the LSSA does the following:

a. Ensures a PS Form 3533 is submitted for each refund. (PS Forms 3533 containing multiple refunds will be rejected.)

b. Ensures Part 1 and Part 2 of PS Form 3533 is completed as detailed in F-101 (21-1.2) subchapter 21-1, Overview.

c. Follows the instructions in Part 6, Disbursements Processed by the Accounting Service Center (ASC), of PS Form 3533.

d. Enters the amount into the corresponding refund AIC and offsets the amount to AIC 280 on the PS Form 1412.

e. Sends the original PS Form 3533 to the SIC for processing:

1. At offices that use the Point of Service (POS) system, attach to PS Form 3533 the system-generated customer receipt (3544) for AIC 280.

2. At offices that use the electronic Money Order Voucher Entry System (eMOVES), attach to PS Form 3533 a copy of the transmitted (printed from eMoves) unit PS Form 1412, which confirms the AIC 280 entry.

f. Submits a copy of the completed PS Form 3533 to the closeout employee as supporting documentation for PS Form 1412.

Note: The customer will receive a commercial check in the mail.

Refunds - Priority Mail Express International Service

As a U.S. sender of a Priority Mail Express International item, you must complete the inquiry process before filing for a postage refund. An inquiry must be initiated within 90 days of the date of mailing by calling the International Inquiry Center at 1-800-222-1811. The Postal Service® will refund postage of Priority Mail Express International items only when...

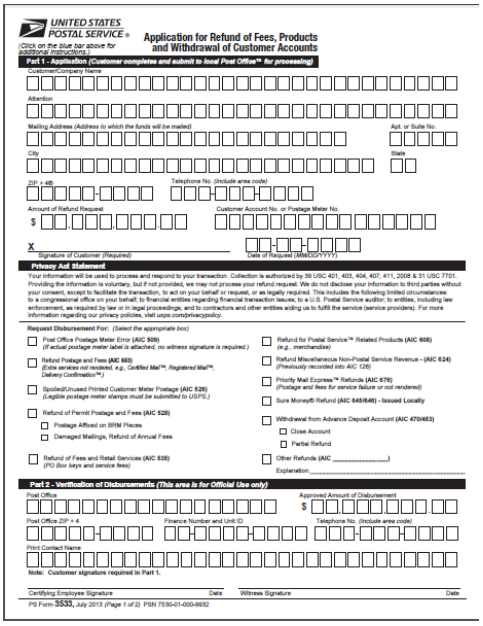
- The inquiry process has confirmed that total loss, damage, or missing contents of a Priority Mail Express International item has occurred.
- The customer has initiated an inquiry within the required 90-day filing period.
- The Expedited Service Specialist has received verification from the Product Tracking System (PTS) or the International Inquiry Center that loss, damage, or missing contents has occurred.
- The customer has received PS Form 3533: Application and Voucher for Refund of Postage, Fees, and Services.

Priority Mail Express International with Guarantee Service

As a U.S. sender of Priority Mail Express International items with Guarantee Service that did not meet the guaranteed delivery date, you must initiate a request for postage refund no later than 30 days from the date of mailing by calling the International Inquiry Center at 1-800-222-1811. The Postal Service will refund postage of Priority Mail Express International with Guarantee service items only when…

- The customer has initiated a request for postage refund within the required 30-day filing period.
- The International Inquiry Center received confirmation from the foreign postal administration that the item did not meet the specified delivery standard.
- The customer has received PS Form 3533-GE: Application and Voucher for Refund of Postage and Fees—Priority Mail Express International with Guarantee Service.

Note: Refunds are requested on PS Form 3533, Application for Refund of Fees, Products, and Withdrawal of Customer Accounts.



UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

(Click on the blue bar above for additional instructions.)

Application for Refund of Fees, Products and Withdrawal of Customer Accounts

Part 1 - Application *(Customer completes and submit to local Post Office™ for processing)*

Customer/Company Name

Attention

Mailing Address (Address to which the funds will be mailed) — Apt. or Suite No.

City — State

ZIP + 4® — Telephone No. (Include area code)

Amount of Refund Request — Customer Account No. or Postage Meter No.

$

X
Signature of Customer (Required) — Date of Request (MM/DD/YYYY)

Privacy Act Statement

Your information will be used to process and respond to your transaction. Collection is authorized by 39 USC 401, 403, 404, 407, 411, 2008 & 31 USC 7701. Providing the information is voluntary, but if not provided, we may not process your refund request. We do not disclose your information to third parties without your consent, except to facilitate the transaction, to act on your behalf or request, or as legally required. This includes the following limited circumstances: to a congressional office on your behalf; to financial entities regarding financial transaction issues; to a U.S. Postal Service auditor; to entities, including law enforcement, as required by law or in legal proceedings; and to contractors and other entities aiding us to fulfill the service (service providers). For more information regarding our privacy policies, visit usps.com/privacypolicy.

Request Disbursement For: *(Select the appropriate box)*

- ☐ Post Office Postage Meter Error **(AIC 509)** *(If actual postage meter label is attached, no witness signature is required.)*
- ☐ Refund Postage and Fees **(AIC 663)** *(Extra services not rendered, e.g., Certified Mail™, Registered Mail™, Delivery Confirmation™.)*
- ☐ Spoiled/Unused Printed Customer Meter Postage **(AIC 526)** *(Legible postage meter stamps must be submitted to USPS.)*
- ☐ Refund of Permit Postage and Fees **(AIC 528)**
  - ☐ Postage Affixed on BRM Pieces
  - ☐ Damaged Mailings, Refund of Annual Fees
- ☐ Refund of Fees and Retail Services **(AIC 536)** *(PO Box keys and service fees)*
- ☐ Refund for Postal Service™ Related Products **(AIC 608)** *(e.g., merchandise)*
- ☐ Refund Miscellaneous Non-Postal Service Revenue – **(AIC 624)** *(Previously recorded into AIC 126)*
- ☐ Priority Mail Express™ Refunds **(AIC 676)** *(Postage and fees for service failure or not rendered)*
- ☐ Sure Money® Refund **(AIC 645/646) - Issued Locally**
- ☐ Withdrawal from Advance Deposit Account **(AIC 470/483)**
  - ☐ Close Account
  - ☐ Partial Refund
- ☐ Other Refunds (AIC _____)

Explanation:

Part 2 - Verification of Disbursements *(This area is for Official Use only)*

Post Office — Approved Amount of Disbursement

$

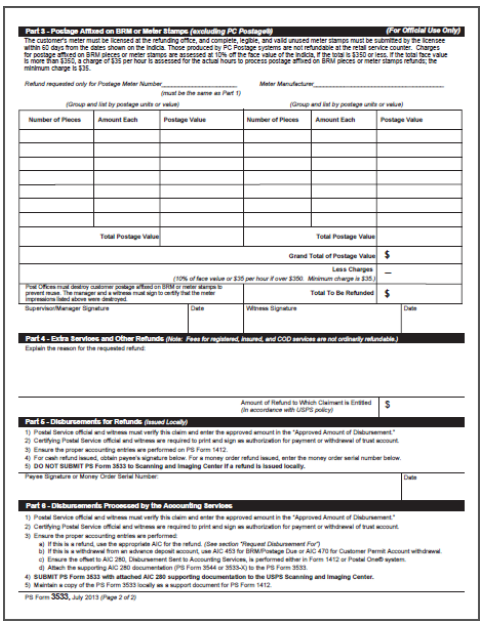
Post Office ZIP + 4 — Finance Number and Unit ID — Telephone No. (Include area code)

Print Contact Name

Note: Customer signature required in Part 1.

Certifying Employee Signature — Date — Witness Signature — Date

PS Form **3533**, July 2013 (Page 1 of 2) PSN 7530-01-000-9932



Part 3 - Postage Affixed on BRM or Meter Stamps (excluding PC Postage®) *(For Official Use Only)*

The customer's meter must be licensed at the refunding office, and complete, legible, and valid unused meter stamps must be submitted by the licensee within 60 days from the dates shown on the indicia. Those produced by PC Postage systems are not refundable at the retail service counter. Charges for postage affixed on BRM pieces or meter stamps are assessed at 10% off the face value of the indicia, if the total is $350 or less. If the total face value is more than $350, a charge of $35 per hour is assessed for the actual hours to process postage affixed on BRM pieces or meter stamps refunds; the minimum charge is $35.

Refund requested only for Postage Meter Number: _____ *(must be the same as Part 1)* — *Meter Manufacturer:* _____

(Group and list by postage units or value)			*(Group and list by postage units or value)*		
Number of Pieces	Amount Each	Postage Value	Number of Pieces	Amount Each	Postage Value
	Total Postage Value			Total Postage Value	

Grand Total of Postage Value $

Less Charges —

(10% of face value or $35 per hour if over $350. Minimum charge is $35.)

Post Offices must destroy customer postage affixed on BRM or meter stamps to prevent reuse. The manager and a witness must sign to certify that the meter impressions listed above were destroyed.

Total To Be Refunded $

Supervisor/Manager Signature — Date — Witness Signature — Date

Part 4 - Extra Services and Other Refunds *(Note: Fees for registered, insured, and COD services are not ordinarily refundable.)*

Explain the reason for the requested refund:

Amount of Refund to Which Claimant is Entitled *(In accordance with USPS policy)* $

Part 5 - Disbursements for Refunds *(Issued Locally)*

1) Postal Service official and witness must verify this claim and enter the approved amount in the "Approved Amount of Disbursement."
2) Certifying Postal Service official and witness are required to print and sign as authorization for payment or withdrawal of trust account.
3) Ensure the proper accounting entries are performed on PS Form 1412.
4) For cash refund issued, obtain payee's signature below. For a money order refund issued, enter the money order serial number below.
5) **DO NOT SUBMIT PS Form 3533 to Scanning and Imaging Center if a refund is issued locally.**

Payee Signature or Money Order Serial Number: — Date

Part 6 - Disbursements Processed by the Accounting Services

1) Postal Service official and witness must verify this claim and enter the approved amount in the "Approved Amount of Disbursement."
2) Certifying Postal Service official and witness are required to print and sign as authorization for payment or withdrawal of trust account.
3) Ensure the proper accounting entries are performed:
   a) If this is a refund, use the appropriate AIC for the refund. *(See section "Request Disbursement For")*
   b) If this is a withdrawal from an advance deposit account, use AIC 453 for BRM/Postage Due or AIC 470 for Customer Permit Account withdrawal.
   c) Ensure the offset to AIC 280, Disbursement Sent to Accounting Services, is performed either in Form 1412 or Postal One® system.
   d) Attach the supporting AIC 280 documentation (PS Form 3544 or 3533-A) to the PS Form 3533.
4) **SUBMIT PS Form 3533 with attached AIC 280 supporting documentation to the USPS Scanning and Imaging Center.**
5) Maintain a copy of the PS Form 3533 locally as a support document for PS Form 1412.

PS Form **3533**, July 2013 (Page 2 of 2)

NOTE: Retail Unit cannot locally issue refunds for more than $500 except when refunding Sure Money principal and fee amounts.

E-2 Quick Reference Table				
Disbursement or Withdrawal	**Amount**	**PS Form Used**	**Process**	**PS Form 1412 Entries**
Postage and Fees				
Refund of postage and fees for services not rendered or for USPS Tracking service (after 30 days).	Up to $500	PS Form 3533	Process reimbursement locally. Issue cash ($25 limit) or no-fee money order. File PS Form 3533 locally.	Enter amount in AIC 553. For no-fee money order offset AIC 553 with AICs 100, 101, and 586. (For AIC 586, POS and eMOVES units use Reason Code 35, Refund — PO Box & Misc. Revenue.)
	$500.01 and greater	PS Form 3533	Forward PS Form 3533 and the required supporting documentation to the SIC.	Enter amount in AIC 280 and offset to AIC 553.
Spoiled Unused Customer Meter Stamps				
Refund of spoiled or unused postage meter.	Up to $500	PS Form 3533	Process reimbursement locally. Issue cash ($25 limit) or no-fee money order. File PS Form 3533 locally.	Enter amount in AIC 526. For a no-fee money order, offset AIC 526 with AICs 100, 101, and 586. (For AIC 586, POS, and eMOVES units use Reason Code 34, Refund — Spoiled/Unused Meter Postage.)
	$500.01 and greater	PS Form 3533	Forward PS Form 3533 and the required supporting documentation to the SIC.	Enter amount in AIC 280 and offset to AIC 526.

Fees and Retail Services				
Refund of Post Office Box keys and refundable Post Office Box and Caller Service fees.	Up to $500	PS Form 3533	Process reimbursement locally. Issue cash ($25 limit) or no-fee money order. File PS Form 3533 locally.	Enter amount in AIC 535. For a no-fee money order, offset AIC 535 with AICs 100, 101, and 586. (For AIC 586, POS, and eMOVES units use Reason Code 35.)
	$500.01 and greater	PS Form 3533	Forward PS Form 3533 and the required supporting documentation to the SIC.	Enter amount in AIC 280 and offset to AIC 535.
Customer Postage Meter Withdrawn				
Amount refunded to customer when removing CMRS postage meter from service.	All	None	Refund processed by postage meter manufacturer.	None.
Priority Mail Express Refunds (EMCA Account)				
Refund of postage and fees to USPS Corporate Accounts for service not rendered as guaranteed.	All	PS Form 3533	Refund processed by district business mail entry (BME), credit to USPSCA account.	None.
Closed USPS Corporate Accounts (USPSCA).	All	Customer's written request and PS Form 3533	Closed account processed by district business mail entry (BME). Forward PS Form 3533 and copy of account inquiry report showing closed account to the SIC.	None.

Priority Mail Express Refunds (Others)				
Refund of postage and fees to other customers (non-USPSCA) for Priority Mail Express service not rendered as guaranteed.	Up to $500	PS Form 3533	Process reimbursement locally. Issue cash ($25 limit) or no-fee money order. File PS Form 3533 locally.	Enter amount in AIC 676. For no-fee money order offset AIC 676 with AICs 100, 101, and 586. (For AIC 586, POS, and eMOVES units use Reason Code 37, Refund —Priority Mail Express .)
	$500.01 and greater	PS Form 3533	Forward PS Form 3533 and the required supporting documentation to the SIC.	Enter amount in AIC 280 and offset to AIC 676.
Sure Money Refunds				
Refunds of Sure Money principal and fee amounts.	All	PS Form 3533	Process reimbursement locally with cash (if available) or issue a no-fee money order. File PS Form 3533 locally.	For cash, use AICs 645 and 646; this decreases cash to bank.
Post Office PVI Label Error				
Spoiled, misprinted, or jammed PVI Labels.	All	PS Form 3533 (PVI Labels attached)	Process reimbursement locally. File PS Form 3533 locally.	Amount already recorded in AIC 109. Enter amount in AIC 553.
Premium Forwarding Service				
Unused portion of the weekly mailing charges. The initial application fee is nonrefundable.	All	PS Form 3533	Annotate the change requested on customer's application. Reimburse locally with a no-fee money order. File PS Form 3533 locally with PFS application.	Enter amount in AIC 623 and offset with AICs 100, 101, and 586. (For AIC 586, POS, and eMOVES units use Reason Code 39, Refund — Premium Forwarding Service.)

Refund: Permit Postage & Fees (*PostalOne!* Offices)				
Funds deposited back to customer's account related to permit mailings, postage amounts of permit mailings damaged by the USPS and annual bulk mailing fee if no mailings are made.	All	PS Form 3533 and *PostalOne!* system-generated PS Form 3533-X	Enter transaction into *PostalOne!* File PS Form 3533 and system-generated PS Form 3533-X locally.	The *PostalOne!* system generates accounting entries to AIC 070 with an offset to AIC 528.
Refund: Permit Postage & Fees (Non-*PostalOne!* Offices)				
Funds deposited back to customer's account related to permit mailings, postage amounts of permit mailings damaged by the USPS, and annual bulk mailing fee if no mailings are made.	All	PS Form 3533	Credit refund amount back to customer's account. File PS Form 3533 locally.	Enter amount in AIC 070 and offset to AIC 528.
Withdrawals: Trust Accounts (*PostalOne!* Offices)				
Withdrawals and disbursements from customer's Permit account maintained at a BMEU or PRU.	All	Customer's written request, PS Form 3533 and *PostalOne!* system-generated PS Form 3533-X	Enter transaction into *PostalOne!* File a copy of the system-generated PS Form 3533-X locally with customer's request. Forward PS Form 3533 and the system-generated PS Form 3533-X to the SIC.	The *PostalOne!* system generates accounting entries to AIC 470 with an offset to AIC 280.

Withdrawals and disbursements from customer's BRM, postage due, MRS, or BPRS account maintained at a BMEU or PRU.	All	Customer's written request, PS Form 3533 and *PostalOne!* system-generated PS Form 3533-X	Enter transaction into *PostalOne!* File a copy of the system-generated PS Form 3533-X locally with customer's request. Forward PS Form 3533 and the system-generated PS Form 3533-X to the SIC.	The *PostalOne!* system generates accounting entries to AIC 453 with an offset to AIC 280.
Withdrawals: Trust Accounts (Non-*PostalOne!* Offices)				
Withdrawals and disbursements from customer's permit account maintained at a PRU.	All	Customer's written request and PS Form 3533	Withdraw amount from customer's account. File a copy of PS Form 3533 locally with customer's request. Forward PS Form 3533 and the required supporting documentation to the SIC.	Enter amount in AIC 280 and offset to AIC 470.
Withdrawals and disbursements from customer's BRM, postage due, MRS, or BPRS account maintained at a PRU.	All	Customer's written request and PS Form 3533	Withdraw amount from customer's account. File a copy of PS Form 3533 locally with customer's request. Forward PS Form 3533 and the required supporting documentation to the SIC.	Enter amount in AIC 280 and offset to AIC 453.

Closing Out Trust Accounts (*PostalOne!* Offices — BMEU)				
Permit — Customer Requested.	All	Customer's written request, PS Form 3533 and *PostalOne!* system-generated PS Form 3533-X	Withdraw amount from customer's account in *PostalOne!* File a copy of the system-generated PS Form 3533-X locally with customer's request.	The *PostalOne!* system generates accounting entries to AIC 470 with an offset to AIC 280.
			Forward PS Form 3533 and the system-generated PS Form 3533-X to the SIC.	
Permit — Postal Service Initiated.	$25 or less	System-generated PS Form 3533-X	BMEU or PRU moves the amount in *PostalOne!* to AIC 126 until customer claims it. File the system-generated PS Form 3533-X locally.	The *PostalOne!* system generates accounting entries to AIC 126 with an offset to AIC 470.
	$25.01 and greater	PS Form 3533 and the *PostalOne!* system-generated PS Form 3533-X	Withdraw amount from customer's account in *PostalOne!* File a copy of the system-generated PS Form 3533-X locally.	The *PostalOne!* system generates accounting entries to AIC 470 with an offset to AIC 280.
			Submit PS Form 3533 and the system-generated PS Form 3533-X to the SIC.	

			Note: If no confirmation of customer's address, withdraw amount from *PostalOne!* and offset to AIC 126 (awaiting customer claim). File the system-generated PS Form 3533-X locally. Do not send any documentation to the SIC.	
Closing Out Trust Accounts (*PostalOne!* Offices — BRM/Postage Due/MRS/BPRS)				
BRM — Customer Requested.	All	Customer's written request, PS Form 3533 and *PostalOne!* system-generated PS Form 3533-X	Enter transaction into *PostalOne!* File a copy of the system-generated PS Form 3533-X locally with customer's request. Forward PS Form 3533 and the system-generated PS Form 3533-X to the SIC.	The *PostalOne!* system generates accounting entries to AIC 453 with an offset to AIC 280.
BRM — Postal Service Initiated.	$25 or less	System-generated PS Form 3533-X	BMEU or PRU moves the amount in *PostalOne!* to AIC 126 until customer claims it. File the system-generated PS Form 3533-X locally	The *PostalOne!* system generates accounting entries to AIC 126 with an offset to AIC 453.
	$25.01 and greater	PS Form 3533 and *PostalOne!* system-generated PS Form	Withdraw amount from customer's account in *PostalOne!* File a copy of the system-generated	The *PostalOne!* system generates accounting entries to AIC 453 with an offset to AIC 280.

		3533-X	PS Form 3533-X locally.	
			Submit PS Form 3533 and the system-generated PS Form 3533-X to the SIC.	
			Note: If no confirmation of customer's address, withdraw amount from *PostalOne!* and offset to AIC 126 (awaiting customer claim). File the system-generated PS Form 3533-X locally. Do not send any documentation to the SIC.	
Closing Out Trust Accounts (Non-*PostalOne!* Permit Offices)				
Permit — Customer Requested.	All	Customer's written request, PS Form 3533	Withdraw amount from customer's account. File a copy of PS Form 3533 locally with customer's request. Forward PS Form 3533 and the required supporting documentation to the SIC.	Enter amount in AIC 280 and offset to AIC 470.
Permit — Postal Service Initiated.	$25 or less	PS Form 3533	Withdraw amount from customer's account. File PS Form 3533 locally with cancellation letter.	Enter amount in AIC 126 and offset to AIC 470.

	$25.01 and greater	PS Form 3533	Withdraw amount from customer's account. File a copy of PS Form 3533 locally. Forward PS Form 3533 and the required supporting documentation to the SIC.	Enter amount in AIC 280 and offset to AIC 470.
			Note: If no confirmation of customer's address, withdraw amount from customer's account using AIC 470 and offset to AIC 126 (awaiting customer claim). File PS Form 3533 locally. Do not send to the SIC.	
Closing Out Trust Accounts (Non-*PostalOne!* Offices — BRM/Postage Due/MRS/BPRS)				
BRM — Customer Requested.	All	Customer's written request, PS Form 3533	Withdraw amount from customer's account. File a copy of PS Form 3533 locally with customer's request. Forward PS Form 3533 and the required supporting documentation to the SIC.	Enter amount in AIC 280 and offset to AIC 453.
BRM — Postal Service Initiated.	$25 or less	PS Form 3533	Withdraw amount from customer's account. File PS Form 3533 locally with cancellation letter.	Enter amount in AIC 126 and offset to AIC 453.

BRM — Postal Service Initiated.	$25.01 and greater	PS Form 3533	Withdraw amount from customer's account. File a copy of PS Form 3533 locally. Forward PS Form 3533 and the required supporting documentation to the SIC. ***Note:*** If no confirmation of customer's address, withdraw amount from customer's account using AIC 453 and offset to AIC 126 (awaiting customer claim). File PS Form 3533 locally. Do not send to the SIC.	Enter amount in AIC 280 and offset to AIC 453.
Value Added Refunds				
Refund to mailers who perform value added service and submit mail at discounted rate.	All	PS Form 3533	Forward the authorized PS Form 3533 to the PRU.	The PRU enters the amount in AIC 280 and offsets to AIC 541. Submit PS Form 3533 and supporting documentation to the SIC.

Group 1 – Priority Mail Express:

Customer needs their package to arrive in one day from one major city to another, so they ask the SSA which service to use. The SSA suggests Priority Mail Express because it provides guaranteed overnight service with a delivery date and time. Customer agrees to pay the extra fee and receives a Priority Mail Express label with their mailing and tracking information in addition to their cash receipt from the POS printer. The customer checks the status of the package using his/her tracking number and discovers that the package did not arrive. The next day they immediately return to the Post Office to obtain a refund. The LSSA or Supervisor reviews and verifies the tracking data, then determines that the customer is due a refund.

Group 2 – Refund of Extra Services Fees – Service not rendered

Customer mails a first class letter and adds Certified and Return Receipt services. SSA informs customer that the added special services will not only provide tracking, but also a date, time and a signed returned card (which will be proof of delivery). A few days pass and the customer checks on the status via the product tracking system. They notice that the only scan showing up is the initial one completed at the retail unit. After seven days, the customer returns to the retail unit and is advised to fill out a PS form 3811A-*Request for Delivery Information/Return Receipt after Mailing*. The form is mailed to the Accepting P.O. to research the matter. After both locations investigate the matter, it is determined neither the letter nor card were ever received. Customer is due a refund.

NOTE: Retail units do not locally issue refunds for more than $500 except when refunding Sure Money principal and fee amounts. (F101, Field Accounting Procedures Guide, Chapter 21, section 21-1)

Summary

Performing counts is a large part of accountability as it directly affects revenue generation. There are counts for cash, stamps, and unit reserves. The results of these counts are part of the daily unit financial report, which will be covered in Module 45. As a Lead Sales and Services Associate, you have the opportunity to reduce the need for customer claims by ensuring proper acceptance procedures are being followed.

Module 5: Daily Unit Financial Report

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Complete PS Form 1412
- Complete PS Form 3959
- Complete PS Form1908/1908z Worksheet

Time Allocated for Module:

- 2 Hours

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion
- Activities

Summary:

- PS Form 1412
- PS Form 3959
- PS Form1908/1908z Worksheet

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide
- Calculators

Media Required:

- Projector
- PowerPoint Presentation
- Rip Charts

PS Form 1412

The PS Form 1412, *Daily Unit Financial Report* is the daily financial report used to report all of an SSA's daily financial transactions. Your ability to close out the unit and make adjustments is important to the financial viability of your unit.

The form provides a running record of receipt controls, stamp accountability, and cash retained. This form is completed everyday business is conducted at the retail counter.

Touring PS Form 1412

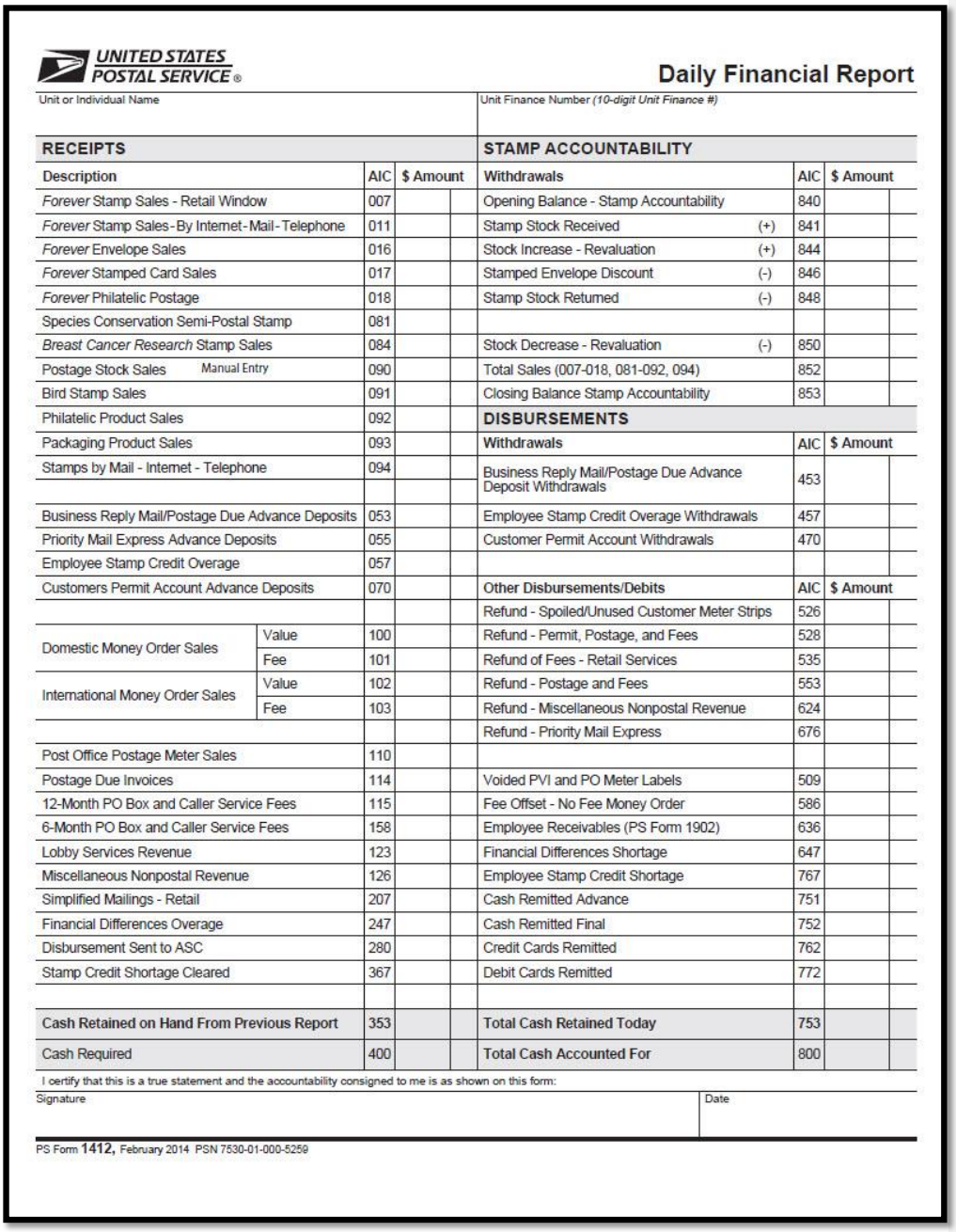
The PS Form 1412 is divided into the following sections:

- Unit ID section
- Receipts (Items that represent money going into the till)
- Stamp Accountability (Tracks accountability from opening to closing)
- Disbursements (Items that represent money coming out of the till)
- Signature section

Account Identifier Codes (AIC)

The Account Identifier Codes (AICs), for Receipts are 001 through 400, Stamp Accountability codes are 840 through 853 and Disbursements 401 through 800.

PS Form 1412



UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Daily Financial Report

Unit or Individual Name

Unit Finance Number *(10-digit Unit Finance #)*

RECEIPTS					STAMP ACCOUNTABILITY				
Description		AIC	$ Amount		Withdrawals		AIC	$ Amount	
Forever Stamp Sales - Retail Window		007			Opening Balance - Stamp Accountability		840		
Forever Stamp Sales - By Internet - Mail - Telephone		011			Stamp Stock Received	(+)	841		
Forever Envelope Sales		016			Stock Increase - Revaluation	(+)	844		
Forever Stamped Card Sales		017			Stamped Envelope Discount	(-)	846		
Forever Philatelic Postage		018			Stamp Stock Returned	(-)	848		
Species Conservation Semi-Postal Stamp		081							
Breast Cancer Research Stamp Sales		084			Stock Decrease - Revaluation	(-)	850		
Postage Stock Sales Manual Entry		090			Total Sales (007-018, 081-092, 094)		852		
Bird Stamp Sales		091			Closing Balance Stamp Accountability		853		
Philatelic Product Sales		092			**DISBURSEMENTS**				
Packaging Product Sales		093			**Withdrawals**		**AIC**	**$ Amount**	
Stamps by Mail - Internet - Telephone		094			Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposit Withdrawals		453		
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposits		053			Employee Stamp Credit Overage Withdrawals		457		
Priority Mail Express Advance Deposits		055			Customer Permit Account Withdrawals		470		
Employee Stamp Credit Overage		057							
Customers Permit Account Advance Deposits		070			**Other Disbursements/Debits**		**AIC**	**$ Amount**	
					Refund - Spoiled/Unused Customer Meter Strips		526		
Domestic Money Order Sales	Value	100			Refund - Permit, Postage, and Fees		528		
	Fee	101			Refund of Fees - Retail Services		535		
International Money Order Sales	Value	102			Refund - Postage and Fees		553		
	Fee	103			Refund - Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue		624		
					Refund - Priority Mail Express		676		
Post Office Postage Meter Sales		110							
Postage Due Invoices		114			Voided PVI and PO Meter Labels		509		
12-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		115			Fee Offset - No Fee Money Order		586		
6-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		158			Employee Receivables (PS Form 1902)		636		
Lobby Services Revenue		123			Financial Differences Shortage		647		
Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue		126			Employee Stamp Credit Shortage		767		
Simplified Mailings - Retail		207			Cash Remitted Advance		751		
Financial Differences Overage		247			Cash Remitted Final		752		
Disbursement Sent to ASC		280			Credit Cards Remitted		762		
Stamp Credit Shortage Cleared		367			Debit Cards Remitted		772		
Cash Retained on Hand From Previous Report		353			**Total Cash Retained Today**		753		
Cash Required		400			**Total Cash Accounted For**		800		

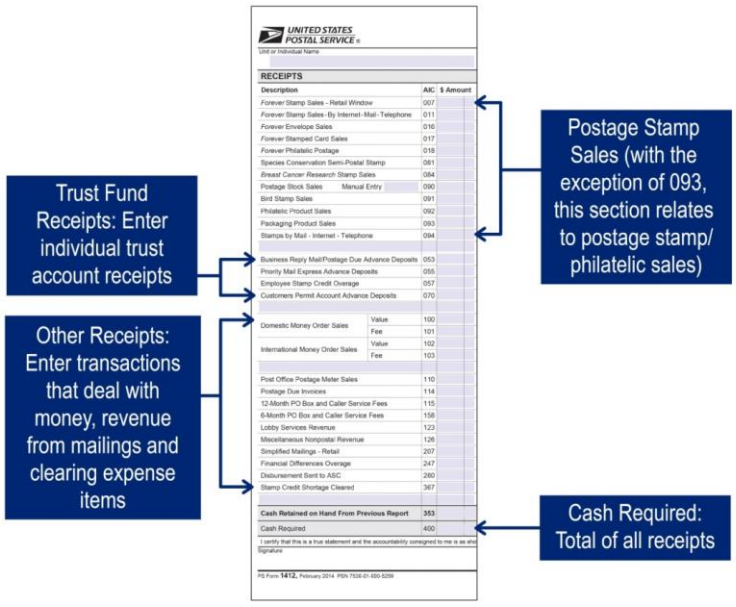
I certify that this is a true statement and the accountability consigned to me is as shown on this form:

Signature | Date

PS Form **1412**, February 2014 PSN 7530-01-000-5259

Left Side of PS Form 1412

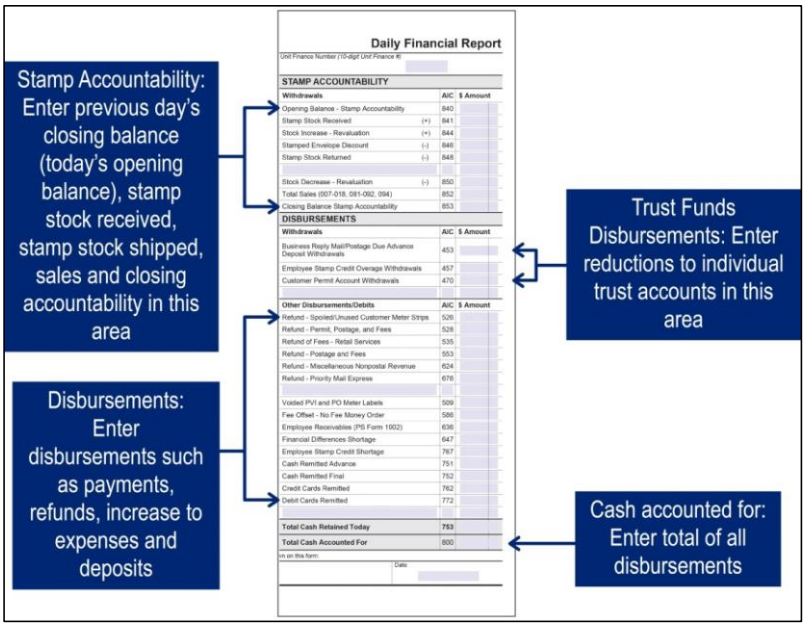
- Record amounts collected for sales of postal products and services provided for that business day, each in their corresponding Account Identifier Code (AIC) in the Receipts section.
- Enter postage stamp sales into AIC 007 through 094.
- Enter receipts to individual trust accounts into the Trust Funds Receipts section between AIC 053 through 070.
- Enter transactions that deal with the receipt of money, revenue from mailings and clearing expense items between AIC 007 through 367.
- Signature of the preparer and date of business goes on bottom of form. Use an ink pen for completion of the PS Form 1412 with signatures and dates. In the event of an error, draw one line through the entry. Write the correction above and initial.



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Right Side of PS Form 1412

- The Right side of PS Form 1412 has two main sections: Stamp Accountability and Disbursements.
- Enter previous day's closing balance (today's opening balance), stamp stock received, stamp stock shipped, sales and closing accountability between AIC 840 through 853.
- Enter reductions to individual trust accounts into the Trust Funds Disbursements section between AIC 453 and 470.
- Enter disbursements such as payments, refunds, increase to expenses and deposits into the Disbursements section between AIC 526 and 772.



Activity: AIC Identification

- Fill in the missing AICs using the information in the Description column.
- Fill in the missing information in the PS Form 1412 Section by determining if the AIC and Description is categorized as Disbursement, Receipt or Stamp Accountability

Comment [SWD1]: AIC answers were left in the PG guide, had to be removed. Added activity instructions.

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AIC Identification Answer Sheet

(AIC)	Description	PS Form 1412 Section
~~753~~	Total Cash Retained	
~~007~~	Forever Stamp Sales / Retail Window	
~~090~~	Postage Stock Sales	
~~752~~	Cash Remitted Final	
~~093~~	Packaging Products Sales	
~~100~~	Domestic Money Orders Value	
~~101~~	Domestic Money Order Fees	
~~453~~	Business Reply Withdrawal Postage Due	
~~676~~	Refund Priority Mail Express	
~~848~~	Stamp Stock Returned	
~~586~~	Fee Offset – No-Fee Money Order	

Shannon's 1412

- Compute the postage sales by copying the totals from the support documents to the corresponding AICs on the PS Form 1412 for Shannon's unit on a typical transaction day.

Shannon's support document totals for unit ID 03132104:

(AIC)	Description	Amount
840	Opening Balance	$2000.00
090	Postage Stock Sales	$488.50
093	Packaging product	$10.00
100	Domestic money order value	$600.00
101	Domestic money order fee	$1.60
102	International money order value	$100.00
103	International money order fee	$4.50
114	Postage Due Invoices	$0.00
123	Lobby services revenue (P.O. Box key)	$2.00
526	Refund customer meter strips	$5.00
752	Cash remitted final	$1101.00
753	Total cash retained today	$100.60

Activity: Shannon's 1412 Answer Sheet

Comment [SWD2]: Image updated and inserted to include opening balance and updated closing balance stamp accountability based on TTT attendee feedback to support the 3959 activity.

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UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Daily Financial Report

Unit or Individual Name: Shannon Last Name

Unit Finance Number *(10-digit Unit Finance #)*:

RECEIPTS

Description		AIC	$ Amount
Forever Stamp Sales - Retail Window		007	
Forever Stamp Sales - By Internet - Mail - Telephone		011	
Forever Envelope Sales		016	
Forever Stamped Card Sales		017	
Forever Philatelic Postage		018	
Species Conservation Semi-Postal Stamp		081	
Breast Cancer Research Stamp Sales		084	
Postage Stock Sales	Manual Entry 488.50	090	488 50
Bird Stamp Sales		091	
Philatelic Product Sales		092	
Packaging Product Sales		093	10 00
Stamps by Mail - Internet - Telephone		094	
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposits		053	
Priority Mail Express Advance Deposits		055	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage		057	
Customers Permit Account Advance Deposits		070	
Domestic Money Order Sales	Value	100	600 00
	Fee	101	1 60
International Money Order Sales	Value	102	100 00
	Fee	103	4 50
Post Office Postage Meter Sales		110	
Postage Due Invoices		114	
12-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		115	
6-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		158	
Lobby Services Revenue		123	2 00
Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue		126	
Simplified Mailings - Retail		207	
Financial Differences Overage		247	
Disbursement Sent to ASC		280	
Stamp Credit Shortage Cleared		367	
Cash Retained on Hand From Previous Report		**353**	
Cash Required		400	1,206 60

STAMP ACCOUNTABILITY

Withdrawals		AIC	$ Amount
Opening Balance - Stamp Accountability		840	2,000 00
Stamp Stock Received	(+)	841	
Stock Increase - Revaluation	(+)	844	
Stamped Envelope Discount	(-)	846	
Stamp Stock Returned	(-)	848	
Stock Decrease - Revaluation	(-)	850	
Total Sales (007-018, 081-092, 094)		852	488 50
Closing Balance Stamp Accountability		853	1,151 50

DISBURSEMENTS

Withdrawals	AIC	$ Amount
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposit Withdrawals	453	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage Withdrawals	457	
Customer Permit Account Withdrawals	470	

Other Disbursements/Debits	AIC	$ Amount
Refund - Spoiled/Unused Customer Meter Strips	526	5 00
Refund - Permit, Postage, and Fees	528	
Refund of Fees - Retail Services	535	
Refund - Postage and Fees	553	
Refund - Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue	624	
Refund - Priority Mail Express	676	
Voided PVI and PO Meter Labels	509	
Fee Offset - No Fee Money Order	586	
Employee Receivables (PS Form 1902)	636	
Financial Differences Shortage	647	
Employee Stamp Credit Shortage	767	
Cash Remitted Advance	751	
Cash Remitted Final	752	1,101 00
Credit Cards Remitted	762	
Debit Cards Remitted	772	
Total Cash Retained Today	**753**	100 60
Total Cash Accounted For	800	1,206 60

I certify that this is a true statement and the accountability consigned to me is as shown on this form:

Signature | Date

PS Form **1412**, February 2014 PSN 7530-01-000-5259

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Daily Financial Report

Unit or Individual Name: Shannon Last Name

Unit Finance Number *(10-digit Unit Finance #)*:

RECEIPTS

Description		AIC	$ Amount
Forever Stamp Sales - Retail Window		007	
Forever Stamp Sales - By Internet - Mail - Telephone		011	
Forever Envelope Sales		016	
Forever Stamped Card Sales		017	
Forever Philatelic Postage		018	
Species Conservation Semi-Postal Stamp		081	
Breast Cancer Research Stamp Sales		084	
Postage Stock Sales	Manual Entry 488.50	090	488.50
Bird Stamp Sales		091	
Philatelic Product Sales		092	
Packaging Product Sales		093	10.00
Stamps by Mail - Internet - Telephone		094	
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposits		053	
Priority Mail Express Advance Deposits		055	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage		057	
Customers Permit Account Advance Deposits		070	
Domestic Money Order Sales	Value	100	600.00
	Fee	101	1.60
International Money Order Sales	Value	102	100.00
	Fee	103	4.50
Post Office Postage Meter Sales		110	
Postage Due Invoices		114	
12-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		115	
6-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		158	
Lobby Services Revenue		123	2.00
Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue		126	
Simplified Mailings - Retail		207	
Financial Differences Overage		247	
Disbursement Sent to ASC		280	
Stamp Credit Shortage Cleared		367	
Cash Retained on Hand From Previous Report		**353**	
Cash Required		400	1,206.60

STAMP ACCOUNTABILITY

Withdrawals		AIC	$ Amount
Opening Balance - Stamp Accountability		840	
Stamp Stock Received	(+)	841	
Stock Increase - Revaluation	(+)	844	
Stamped Envelope Discount	(-)	846	
Stamp Stock Returned	(-)	848	
Stock Decrease - Revaluation	(-)	850	
Total Sales (007-018, 081-092, 094)		852	488.50
Closing Balance Stamp Accountability		853	-488.50

DISBURSEMENTS

Withdrawals	AIC	$ Amount
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposit Withdrawals	453	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage Withdrawals	457	
Customer Permit Account Withdrawals	470	
Other Disbursements/Debits	**AIC**	**$ Amount**
Refund - Spoiled/Unused Customer Meter Strips	526	5.00
Refund - Permit, Postage, and Fees	528	
Refund of Fees - Retail Services	535	
Refund - Postage and Fees	553	
Refund - Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue	624	
Refund - Priority Mail Express	676	
Voided PVI and PO Meter Labels	509	
Fee Offset - No Fee Money Order	586	
Employee Receivables (PS Form 1902)	636	
Financial Differences Shortage	647	
Employee Stamp Credit Shortage	767	
Cash Remitted Advance	751	
Cash Remitted Final	752	1,101.00
Credit Cards Remitted	762	
Debit Cards Remitted	772	
Total Cash Retained Today	**753**	100.60
Total Cash Accounted For	800	1,206.60

I certify that this is a true statement and the accountability consigned to me is as shown on this form:

Signature | Date

PS Form **1412**, February 2014 PSN 7530-01-000-5259

Comment [SWD3]: Image deleted and replaced with new one to include opening balance and updated closing balance stamp accountability based on TTT attendee feedback to support the 3959 activity.

Completed Unit 1412

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Daily Financial Report

Unit or Individual Name

Unit Finance Number *(10-digit Unit Finance #)*

RECEIPTS				STAMP ACCOUNTABILITY			
Description	**AIC**	**$ Amount**		**Withdrawals**	**AIC**	**$ Amount**	
Forever Stamp Sales - Retail Window	007			Opening Balance - Stamp Accountability	840	62,000	00
Forever Stamp Sales - By Internet - Mail - Telephone	011			Stamp Stock Received (+)	841		
Forever Envelope Sales	016			Stock Increase - Revaluation (+)	844		
Forever Stamped Card Sales	017			Stamped Envelope Discount (-)	846		
Forever Philatelic Postage	018			Stamp Stock Returned (-)	848		
Species Conservation Semi-Postal Stamp	081						
Breast Cancer Research Stamp Sales	084			Stock Decrease - Revaluation (-)	850		
Postage Stock Sales Manual Entry 968.50	090	968	50	Total Sales (007-018, 081-092, 094)	852	968	50
Bird Stamp Sales	091			Closing Balance Stamp Accountability	853	61,031	50
Philatelic Product Sales	092			**DISBURSEMENTS**			
Packaging Product Sales	093	10	00	**Withdrawals**	**AIC**	**$ Amount**	
Stamps by Mail - Internet - Telephone	094			Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposit Withdrawals	453	50	00
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposits	053			Employee Stamp Credit Overage Withdrawals	457		
Priority Mail Express Advance Deposits	055			Customer Permit Account Withdrawals	470		
Employee Stamp Credit Overage	057						
Customers Permit Account Advance Deposits	070			**Other Disbursements/Debits**	**AIC**	**$ Amount**	
				Refund - Spoiled/Unused Customer Meter Strips	526	5	00
Domestic Money Order Sales — Value	100	630	00	Refund - Permit, Postage, and Fees	528		
Domestic Money Order Sales — Fee	101	2	80	Refund of Fees - Retail Services	535		
International Money Order Sales — Value	102	100	00	Refund - Postage and Fees	553		
International Money Order Sales — Fee	103	4	50	Refund - Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue	624		
				Refund - Priority Mail Express	676	30	00
Post Office Postage Meter Sales	110						
Postage Due Invoices	114	58	00	Voided PVI and PO Meter Labels	509		
12-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees	115	20	00	Fee Offset - No Fee Money Order	586	1	20
6-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees	158			Employee Receivables (PS Form 1902)	636		
Lobby Services Revenue	123	2	00	Financial Differences Shortage	647		
Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue	126			Employee Stamp Credit Shortage	767		
Simplified Mailings - Retail	207			Cash Remitted Advance	751		
Financial Differences Overage	247			Cash Remitted Final	752	1,509	00
Disbursement Sent to ASC	280			Credit Cards Remitted	762		
Stamp Credit Shortage Cleared	367			Debit Cards Remitted	772		
Cash Retained on Hand From Previous Report	**353**			**Total Cash Retained Today**	**753**	200	60
Cash Required	400	1,795	80	**Total Cash Accounted For**	800	1,795	80

I certify that this is a true statement and the accountability consigned to me is as shown on this form:

Signature | Date

PS Form **1412,** February 2014 PSN 7530-01-000-5259

Preliminary Unit 1412 with Errors / Discrepancies

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Daily Financial Report

Unit or Individual Name

Unit Finance Number *(10-digit Unit Finance #)*

RECEIPTS

Description		AIC	$ Amount
Forever Stamp Sales - Retail Window		007	
Forever Stamp Sales - By Internet - Mail - Telephone		011	
Forever Envelope Sales		016	
Forever Stamped Card Sales		017	
Forever Philatelic Postage		018	
Species Conservation Semi-Postal Stamp		081	
Breast Cancer Research Stamp Sales		084	
Postage Stock Sales Manual Entry 968.50		090	968 50
Bird Stamp Sales		091	
Philatelic Product Sales		092	
Packaging Product Sales		093	10 00
Stamps by Mail - Internet - Telephone		094	
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposits		053	
Priority Mail Express Advance Deposits		055	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage		057	
Customers Permit Account Advance Deposits		070	
Domestic Money Order Sales	Value	100	630 00
	Fee	101	2 80
International Money Order Sales	Value	102	100 00
	Fee	103	4 50
Post Office Postage Meter Sales		110	50.00
Postage Due Invoices		114	~~58 00~~
12-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		115	20 00
6-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		158	
Lobby Services Revenue		123	2 00
Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue		126	
Simplified Mailings - Retail		207	
Financial Differences Overage		247	8 00
Disbursement Sent to ASC		280	
Stamp Credit Shortage Cleared		367	
Cash Retained on Hand From Previous Report		**353**	
Cash Required		400	1,715 80

STAMP ACCOUNTABILITY

Withdrawals		AIC	$ Amount
Opening Balance - Stamp Accountability		840	62,000 00
Stamp Stock Received	(+)	841	
Stock Increase - Revaluation	(+)	844	
Stamped Envelope Discount	(-)	846	
Stamp Stock Returned	(-)	848	
Stock Decrease - Revaluation	(-)	850	
Total Sales (007-018, 081-092, 094)		852	968 50
Closing Balance Stamp Accountability		853	61,031 50

DISBURSEMENTS

Withdrawals	AIC	$ Amount
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposit Withdrawals	453	50 00
Employee Stamp Credit Overage Withdrawals	457	
Customer Permit Account Withdrawals	470	

Other Disbursements/Debits	AIC	$ Amount
Refund - Spoiled/Unused Customer Meter Strips	526	5 00
Refund - Permit, Postage, and Fees	528	
Refund of Fees - Retail Services	535	
Refund - Postage and Fees	553	
Refund - Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue	624	
Refund - Priority Mail Express	676	30 00
Voided PVI and PO Meter Labels	509	
Fee Offset - No Fee Money Order	586	1 20
Employee Receivables (PS Form 1902)	636	
Financial Differences Shortage	647	
Employee Stamp Credit Shortage	767	
Cash Remitted Advance	751	
Cash Remitted Final	752	1,509 00
Credit Cards Remitted	762	
Debit Cards Remitted	772	
Total Cash Retained Today	**753**	200 60
Total Cash Accounted For	800	1,715 80

I certify that this is a true statement and the accountability consigned to me is as shown on this form:

Signature | Date

PS Form **1412,** February 2014 PSN 7530-01-000-5259

~~Unit 1412 with Handwritten Correction to AICs~~

Comment [SWD4]: During the TTT attendees felt this page wasn't needed and confused the next part of the activity. It was deleted.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Daily Financial Report

Unit or Individual Name

Unit Finance Number *(10-digit Unit Finance #)*

RECEIPTS

Description		AIC	$ Amount
Forever Stamp Sales - Retail Window		007	
Forever Stamp Sales - By Internet - Mail - Telephone		011	
Forever Envelope Sales		016	
Forever Stamped Card Sales		017	
Forever Philatelic Postage		018	
Species Conservation Semi-Postal Stamp		081	
Breast Cancer Research Stamp Sales		084	
Postage Stock Sales Manual Entry 968.50		090	968 50
Bird Stamp Sales		091	
Philatelic Product Sales		092	
Packaging Product Sales		093	10 00
Stamps by Mail - Internet - Telephone		094	
		090	968 50
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposits		053	
Priority Mail Express Advance Deposits		055	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage		057	
Customers Permit Account Advance Deposits		070	
Domestic Money Order Sales	Value	100	630 00
	Fee	101	2 80
International Money Order Sales	Value	102	100 00
	Fee	103	4 50
Post Office Postage Meter Sales		110	
Postage Due Invoices		114	50 00
12-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		115	20 00
6-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		158	
Lobby Services Revenue		123	2 00
Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue		126	
Simplified Mailings - Retail		207	
Financial Differences Overage		247	
Disbursement Sent to ASC		280	
Stamp Credit Shortage Cleared		367	

STAMP ACCOUNTABILITY

Withdrawals		AIC	$ Amount
Opening Balance - Stamp Accountability		840	60,000 00
Stamp Stock Received	(+)	841	
Stock Increase - Revaluation	(+)	844	
Stamped Envelope Discount	(-)	846	
Stamp Stock Returned	(-)	848	
Retail Floor Stock			2,000 00
Stock Decrease - Revaluation	(-)	850	
Total Sales (007-018, 081-092, 094)		852	968 50
Closing Balance Stamp Accountability		853	61,031 50

DISBURSEMENTS

Withdrawals	AIC	$ Amount
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposit Withdrawals	453	50 00
Employee Stamp Credit Overage Withdrawals	457	
Customer Permit Account Withdrawals	470	
		50 00

Other Disbursements/Debits	AIC	$ Amount
Refund - Spoiled/Unused Customer Meter Strips	526	5 00
Refund - Permit, Postage, and Fees	528	
Refund of Fees - Retail Services	535	
Refund - Postage and Fees	553	
Refund - Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue	624	
Refund - Priority Mail Express	676	30 00
Voided PVI and PO Meter Labels	509	
Fee Offset - No Fee Money Order	586	1 20
Employee Receivables (PS Form 1902)	636	
Financial Differences Shortage	647	
Employee Stamp Credit Shortage	767	
Cash Remitted Advance	751	
Cash Remitted Final	752	1,509 00
Credit Cards Remitted	762	
Debit Cards Remitted	772	

Cash Retained on Hand From Previous Report	**353**	**Total Cash Retained Today**	**753**	200 60
Cash Required	400	1,787 80	**Total Cash Accounted For**	**800**	1,715 80

I certify that this is a true statement and the accountability consigned to me is as shown on this form:

Signature | Date

PS Form **1412,** February 2014 PSN 7530-01-000-5259

1412 Corrections

The following chart will lead you through four steps in making a correction at the unit level. The steps are noted just above the chart.

The consolidator will do the following:

Step 1: Determine the error.

Step 2: Change the AIC that is wrong to the correct amount on the Unit 1412.

Step 3: Offset that correction.

Step 4: The following day the Sales and Services Associate will clear that offset.

Financial discrepancies (also known as an "expense") between form 1412 and the supporting documentation must be adjusted and offset using either AIC 247 (Financial Differences-Overages) or AIC 647 (Financial Differences-Shortages). Entries in AIC 247(an increase) or AIC 647(a decrease) will directly affect your AIC 752 (cash amounts).

Accounting terms and their meanings:

Overstated (aka Over reported) – amount is higher than it should be (shortage-647)

Understated (aka Underreported) - amount is lower than it should be (overage-247)

Accountability Adjustment Table for Errors Corrected at Unit Level

DAY ADJUSTMENT IS MADE					ASSOCIATES NEXT WORK DAY
Step 1		**Step 2**	**Step 3**		**Step 4**
Error	**Result of Error**	**Correction Entry by Unit**	**Offset Entry by Unit**		**Associates 1412 Adjustment**
Over-reported Receipt	Credit is short	Reduce the Receipt to the correct amount	Create offsetting overage **AIC/GLA 247**		Clear offset with **AIC/GLA 647**
Under-reported Receipt	Credit is over	Increase the Receipt to the correct amount	Create offsetting shortage **AIC/GLA 647**		Clear offset with **AIC/GLA 247**
Over-reported Disbursement	Credit is over	Reduce the Disbursement to the correct amount	Create offsetting shortage **AIC/GLA 647**		Clear offset with **AIC/GLA 247**
Under-reported Disbursement	Credit is short	Increase the Disbursement to the correct amount	Create offsetting overage **AIC/GLA 247**		Withdraw Amount From Trust **AIC/GLA 647**

Correcting Financial Discrepancies using PS Form 1908/1908z

PS Form 1908 - *Financial Adjustment Memorandum* (supporting documentation) is issued to an employee to notify him/her about a shortage or overage "expense" (financial difference). It also provides instructions to the employee about how to clear/offset the "expense".

- This form should be completed in triplicate.
- Issue the original and one copy to the SSA and maintain one copy for the unit in a "pending file."
- Once the SSA makes their entry on their 1412, they need to sign PS Form 1908 and turn it in with their (1412) paperwork.
- The SSA will retain the original PS Form 1908 until their next credit audit.
- This is how you record an expense and offset: Verify 1412 (SSAs and Unit 1412).

- Review AICs and amounts, create expenses for overages and shortages, offset previous expense and document the expense.

N**ote:** The POS One and e1412 systems generate a nine digit reference number when creating a financial adjustment overage (247) or shortage (647) locally. The reference number is used for reporting and tracking the financial adjustment and the reference number will be required when clearing a financial adjustment. This way all clearing entries are linked directly to the original financial adjustment. All transactions that result in Financial Difference items AIC 247/647 entries are maintained in a log for each POS unit called the Financial Differences History-Unit Report from POS. For e1412 units, AIC 247/647 entries are maintained in a log called Financial Difference Over/Short (AIC 247/647).

Touring PS Form 1908/1908z Worksheet

The PS Form 1908/1908z is divided into the following 3 sections:

- Unit Format
- SSA's Format
- 1908

1908/1908z Worksheet

1908 WORKSHEET

(1) Correct SSA'S 1412 with RED ink then adjust the Unit Financial Report (1412)

UNIT FORMAT

LOCATION OF ERROR	TYPE	UNIT 1412 CORRECTION	AMOUNT	UNIT 1412 AIC# (that needs corrected)	AMOUNT
RECEIPT	OVERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 247		REDUCE AIC#	
	UNDERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 647		INCREASE AIC#	
DISBURSEMENT	OVERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 647		REDUCE AIC#	
	UNDERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 247		INCREASE AIC#	

(2) Process form 1908 to correct clerk's accountability on next 1412 report.

SSA's FORMAT

LOCATION OF ERROR	TYPE	SSA's CORRECTION	AMOUNT	SSA's OFFSET AIC#	AMOUNT
RECEIPT	OVERREPORTED	TRUST W/D AIC647		DECREASE AIC 752	
	UNDERREPORTED	CLEAR SUSP AIC247		INCREASE AIC 752	
DISBURSEMENT	OVERREPORTED	CLEAR SUSP AIC247		INCREASE AIC 752	
	UNDERREPORTED	TRUST W/D AIC647		DECREASE AIC 752	

(3) Fill out & issue 1908 in the format below. (in triplicate); verify that action is taken to clear.

U.S. POSTAL SERVICE

FINANCIAL ADJUSTMENT MEMORANDUM

(Prepare in triplicate: Original and 1 copy to reporting unit.(for SSA) Retain triplicate)

EXAMINATION of the financial report indicated showed discrepancies as described below. If an adjustment is required, please indicate the adjustment made and return the duplicate copy of this memorandum with the next 1412 report.

(Postmaster, Station Mgr., SSA, Military PO,)

Financial Report (Check applicable item)	Dated
Form 1412	
Form 8019-mpo	
Bank Deposit Slip	

The deposit shown below indicated this discrepancy:

Form 1412 Date	Amount of Deposit	Amount Verified by Bank

Make the necessary adjustment on your next Form 1412 or Form 8019.

The indicated Form 1412 AIC or Form 8019 Item PLO. Contained this discrepancy:

Date/No.	Explanation
	AIC# _____(where error was found) Reported on 1412: $_____ Actual: $_____ (amount on supporting document) Difference: $_____

Make These Adjusting Entries

($ amount is from 'difference' in explanation)

AIC# _____ **$** _____

(above AIC# should be either 247 or 647)

AIC# 752 **$** _____

Sign: verifying adjustment has been made:

_____

Date	Prepared by (Unit)	Signature(prepared by)

PS Form 1908Z

PS Form 1908Z http://blue.usps.gov/customerservicesoperationsandretail/customerservicesoperations/customerservices/xls/wos_1908_safr_worksheet_25july05.xls?popup=true

Unit Format

A) LOCATION OF THE ERROR: Review the SSA's 1412 (incl. supporting documentation) and Unit 1412 entries to determine where AIC is listed. Is it under RECEIPTS (AICs 001 thru 399) or DISBURSEMENTS (AIC 401-799)

B) TYPE: What type of error is it? Is it OVERREPORTED (listed amount is greater than the physical amount) or UNDERREPORTED (listed amount is less than the physical amount)

C) UNIT 1412 CORRECTION: Column will tell you which financial adjustment (either 247-overage or 647-shortage) needs to be created by the UNIT.

D) AMOUNT: Enter the dollar amount in the column

E) UNIT 1412 AIC # (that needs to be corrected) Enter the AIC number that has the discrepancy (i.e. 115-P.O. Boxes).

F) AMOUNT: Enter the dollar (or discrepancy) amount in the column

SSA Format

A) LOCATION OF THE ERROR: Review the SSA's 1412 (incl. supporting documentation) and Unit 1412 entries to determine if the AIC is listed under **RECEIPTS (**AICs 001 thru 399) or **DISBURSEMENTS** (AIC 401-799)?

B) TYPE: What type of error is it? Is it **OVERREPORTED** (listed amount is greater than the physical amount) or **UNDERREPORTED** (listed amount is less than the physical amount)?

C) SSA's CORRECTION: What type of financial adjustment (either 247-overage or 647-shortage) was created by the Unit and needs to be cleared/offset by the SSA. (i.e. If the unit created an overage for an employee, then the SSA would have to clear this adjustment with a shortage

D) AMOUNT: Enter the dollar amount in the column

E) SSA's OFFSET AIC # - system defaults to AIC 752 (cash) for the offset AIC.

F) AMOUNT: Enter the dollar amount in the column

1908

A) Postmaster, Station Mgr., SSA, or Military PO: List name of SSA that had the discrepancy on their 1412

B) Financial Report: write in the date next to the applicable item

C) Date/No: Fill in date of initial adjustment

D) Explanation: Refer to Section 1 – **UNIT FORMAT -** Fill in (affected) AIC number listed under **UNIT 1412 AIC # (that needs to be corrected)**, **AMOUNT** reported on SSA's 1412, Actual cash **AMOUNT** entered that he or she should have reported or turned in. **AMOUNT** on their supporting documentation (the difference between the AIC entry and amount it should be) and the **DIFFERENCE**.

E) Make These Adjusting Entries: Refer to Section 2 – **SSA FORMAT**, **SSA's CORRECTION** (lists clearing AIC), **AMOUNT** (of discrepancy), **SSA's OFFSET AIC #** (defaults to AIC 752) and **AMOUNT** that will go into this AIC.

Completed 1908/1908z for the Unit 1412 Over Reported Amount

1908 WORKSHEET

(1) Correct SSA'S 1412 with RED ink then adjust the Unit Financial Report (1412)

UNIT FORMAT

LOCATION OF ERROR	TYPE	UNIT 1412 CORRECTION	AMOUNT	UNIT 1412 AIC# (that needs corrected)	AMOUNT
RECEIPT	OVERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 247	8.00	REDUCE AIC# 114	8.00
	UNDERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 647		INCREASE AIC#	
DISBURSEMENT	OVERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 647		REDUCE AIC#	
	UNDERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 247		INCREASE AIC#	

(2) Process form 1908 to correct clerk's accountability on next 1412 report.

SSA's FORMAT

LOCATION OF ERROR	TYPE	SSA's CORRECTION	AMOUNT	SSA's OFFSET AIC#	AMOUNT
RECEIPT	OVERREPORTED	TRUST W/D AIC647	8.00	DECREASE AIC 752	8.00
	UNDERREPORTED	CLEAR SUSP AIC247		INCREASE AIC 752	
DISBURSEMENT	OVERREPORTED	CLEAR SUSP AIC247		INCREASE AIC 752	
	UNDERREPORTED	TRUST W/D AIC647		DECREASE AIC 752	

(3) Fill out & issue 1908 in the format below. (in triplicate); verify that action is taken to clear.

U.S. POSTAL SERVICE
FINANCIAL ADJUSTMENT MEMORANDUM
(Prepare in triplicate: Original and 1 copy to reporting unit.(for SSA) Retain triplicate)

EXAMINATION of the financial report indicated showed discrepancies as described below. If an adjustment is required, please indicate the adjustment made and return the duplicate copy of this memorandum with the next 1412 report.

(Postmaster, Station Mgr., SSA, Military PO,)

Name

Financial Report (Check applicable item)	Dated
Form 1412	99/99/9999
Form 8019-mpo	
Bank Deposit Slip	

The deposit shown below indicated this discrepancy:

Form 1412 Date	Amount of Deposit	Amount Verified by Bank

Make the necessary adjustment on your next Form 1412 or Form 8019.

The indicated Form 1412 AIC or Form 8019 Item PLO. Contained this discrepancy:

Date/No.	Explanation
99/99/9999	AIC# 114 (where error was found) Reported on 1412: $ 58.00 Actual: $ 50.00 (amount on supporting document) Difference: $ 8.00

Make These Adjusting Entries

($ amount is from 'difference' in explanation)
AIC# 647 **$** 8.00
(above AIC# should be either 247 or 647)

AIC# 752 **$** 8.00

Sign: verifying adjustment has been made:
Signature

Date | Prepared by (Unit) | Signature(prepared by)

PS Form 1908Z

PS Form 1908Z 1908 Guide sheet.xls 1908 worksheet

Comment [SWD5]: AIC was corrected in the "Make these Adjusting Entries" section from 247 to 647 based on TTT attendee feedback. Image updated and inserted.

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Comment [SWD6]: AIC was corrected in the "Make these Adjusting Entries" section from 247 to 647 based on TTT attendee feedback. Old image deleted.

1908 WORKSHEET

(1) Correct SSA'S 1412 with RED ink then adjust the Unit Financial Report (1412)

UNIT FORMAT

LOCATION OF ERROR	TYPE	UNIT 1412 CORRECTION	AMOUNT	UNIT 1412 AIC# (that needs corrected)	AMOUNT
RECEIPT	OVERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 247	8.00	REDUCE AIC# 114	8.00
	UNDERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 647		INCREASE AIC#	
DISBURSEMENT	OVERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 647		REDUCE AIC#	
	UNDERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 247		INCREASE AIC#	

(2) Process form 1908 to correct clerk's accountability on next 1412 report.

SSA's FORMAT

LOCATION OF ERROR	TYPE	SSA's CORRECTION	AMOUNT	SSA's OFFSET AIC#	AMOUNT
RECEIPT	OVERREPORTED	TRUST W/D AIC647	8.00	DECREASE AIC 752	8.00
	UNDERREPORTED	CLEAR SUSP AIC247		INCREASE AIC 752	
DISBURSEMENT	OVERREPORTED	CLEAR SUSP AIC247		INCREASE AIC 752	
	UNDERREPORTED	TRUST W/D AIC647		DECREASE AIC 752	

(3) Fill out & issue 1908 in the format below. (in triplicate); verify that action is taken to clear.

U.S. POSTAL SERVICE

FINANCIAL ADJUSTMENT MEMORANDUM

(Prepare in triplicate: Original and 1 copy to reporting unit (for SSA) Retain triplicate)

EXAMINATION of the financial report indicated showed discrepancies as described below. If an adjustment is required, please indicate the adjustment made and return the duplicate copy of this memorandum with the next 1412 report.

(Postmaster, Station Mgr., SSA, Military PO,)

Name

Financial Report (Check applicable item)	Dated
Form 1412	99/99/9999
Form 8019-mpo	
Bank Deposit Slip	

The deposit shown below indicated this discrepancy:

Form 1412 Date	Amount of Deposit	Amount Verified by Bank

Make the necessary adjustment on your next Form 1412 or Form 8019.

The indicated Form 1412 AIC or Form 8019 Item PLO. Contained this discrepancy:

Date/No.	Explanation
99/99/9999	AIC# 114 (where error was found) Reported on 1412: $ 58.00 Actual: $ 50.00 (amount on supporting document) Difference: $ 8.00
Date	Prepared by (Unit)

Make These Adjusting Entries

($ amount is from 'difference' in explanation)

AIC# 247 **$** 8.00

(above AIC# should be either 247 or 647)

AIC# 752 **$** 8.00

Sign: verifying adjustment has been made:

Signature

Signature(prepared by)

PS Form 1908Z

PS Form 1908Z 1908 Guide sheet.xls 1908 worksheet

Shannon's 1412 with Discrepancy on AIC 526

Comment [SWD7]: Based on TTT attendee feedback image was updated to include opening balance which modified the closing balance stamp accountability to support the 3959 activity.

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UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Daily Financial Report

Unit or Individual Name: Shannon Last Name

Unit Finance Number *(10-digit Unit Finance #)*:

RECEIPTS				STAMP ACCOUNTABILITY			
Description		**AIC**	**$ Amount**	**Withdrawals**		**AIC**	**$ Amount**
Forever Stamp Sales - Retail Window		007		Opening Balance - Stamp Accountability		840	2,000 00
Forever Stamp Sales - By Internet - Mail - Telephone		011		Stamp Stock Received	(+)	841	
Forever Envelope Sales		016		Stock Increase - Revaluation	(+)	844	
Forever Stamped Card Sales		017		Stamped Envelope Discount	(-)	846	
Forever Philatelic Postage		018		Stamp Stock Returned	(-)	848	
Species Conservation Semi-Postal Stamp		081					
Breast Cancer Research Stamp Sales		084		Stock Decrease - Revaluation	(-)	850	
Postage Stock Sales Manual Entry 488.50		090	488 50	Total Sales (007-018, 081-092, 094)		852	488 50
Bird Stamp Sales		091		Closing Balance Stamp Accountability		853	1,151 50
Philatelic Product Sales		092		**DISBURSEMENTS**			
Packaging Product Sales		093	10 00	**Withdrawals**		**AIC**	**$ Amount**
Stamps by Mail - Internet - Telephone		094		Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposit Withdrawals		453	
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposits		053		Employee Stamp Credit Overage Withdrawals		457	
Priority Mail Express Advance Deposits		055		Customer Permit Account Withdrawals		470	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage		057					
Customers Permit Account Advance Deposits		070		**Other Disbursements/Debits**		**AIC**	**$ Amount**
				Refund - Spoiled/Unused Customer Meter Strips		526	5 00
Domestic Money Order Sales	Value	100	600 00	Refund - Permit, Postage, and Fees		528	
	Fee	101	1 60	Refund of Fees - Retail Services		535	
International Money Order Sales	Value	102	100 00	Refund - Postage and Fees		553	
	Fee	103	4 50	Refund - Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue		624	
				Refund - Priority Mail Express		676	
Post Office Postage Meter Sales		110					
Postage Due Invoices		114		Voided PVI and PO Meter Labels		509	
12-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		115		Fee Offset - No Fee Money Order		586	
6-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		158		Employee Receivables (PS Form 1902)		636	
Lobby Services Revenue		123	2 00	Financial Differences Shortage		647	
Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue		126		Employee Stamp Credit Shortage		767	
Simplified Mailings - Retail		207		Cash Remitted Advance		751	
Financial Differences Overage		247		Cash Remitted Final		752	1,101 00
Disbursement Sent to ASC		280		Credit Cards Remitted		762	
Stamp Credit Shortage Cleared		367		Debit Cards Remitted		772	
Cash Retained on Hand From Previous Report		**353**		**Total Cash Retained Today**		**753**	100 60
Cash Required		400	1,206 60	**Total Cash Accounted For**		800	1,206 60

I certify that this is a true statement and the accountability consigned to me is as shown on this form:

Signature | Date

PS Form **1412**, February 2014 PSN 7530-01-000-5259

Comment [SWD8]: Old version deleted.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Daily Financial Report

Unit or Individual Name: Shannon Last Name

Unit Finance Number *(10-digit Unit Finance #)*:

RECEIPTS

Description		AIC	$ Amount
Forever Stamp Sales - Retail Window		007	
Forever Stamp Sales - By Internet - Mail - Telephone		011	
Forever Envelope Sales		016	
Forever Stamped Card Sales		017	
Forever Philatelic Postage		018	
Species Conservation Semi-Postal Stamp		081	
Breast Cancer Research Stamp Sales		084	
Postage Stock Sales	Manual Entry 488.50	090	488 50
Bird Stamp Sales		091	
Philatelic Product Sales		092	
Packaging Product Sales		093	10 00
Stamps by Mail - Internet - Telephone		094	
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposits		053	
Priority Mail Express Advance Deposits		055	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage		057	
Customers Permit Account Advance Deposits		070	
Domestic Money Order Sales	Value	100	600 00
	Fee	101	1 60
International Money Order Sales	Value	102	100 00
	Fee	103	4 50
Post Office Postage Meter Sales		110	
Postage Due Invoices		114	
12-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		115	
6-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		158	
Lobby Services Revenue		123	2 00
Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue		126	
Simplified Mailings - Retail		207	
Financial Differences Overage		247	
Disbursement Sent to ASC		280	
Stamp Credit Shortage Cleared		367	
Cash Retained on Hand From Previous Report		**353**	
Cash Required		400	1,206 60

STAMP ACCOUNTABILITY

Withdrawals		AIC	$ Amount
Opening Balance - Stamp Accountability		840	
Stamp Stock Received	(+)	841	
Stock Increase - Revaluation	(+)	844	
Stamped Envelope Discount	(-)	846	
Stamp Stock Returned	(-)	848	
Stock Decrease - Revaluation	(-)	850	
Total Sales (007-018, 081-092, 094)		852	488 50
Closing Balance Stamp Accountability		853	-488 50

DISBURSEMENTS

Withdrawals	AIC	$ Amount
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposit Withdrawals	453	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage Withdrawals	457	
Customer Permit Account Withdrawals	470	

Other Disbursements/Debits	AIC	$ Amount
Refund - Spoiled/Unused Customer Meter Strips	526	5 00
Refund - Permit, Postage, and Fees	528	
Refund of Fees - Retail Services	535	
Refund - Postage and Fees	553	
Refund - Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue	624	
Refund - Priority Mail Express	676	
Voided PVI and PO Meter Labels	509	
Fee Offset - No Fee Money Order	586	
Employee Receivables (PS Form 1902)	636	
Financial Differences Shortage	647	
Employee Stamp Credit Shortage	767	
Cash Remitted Advance	751	
Cash Remitted Final	752	1,101 00
Credit Cards Remitted	762	
Debit Cards Remitted	772	
Total Cash Retained Today	**753**	100 60
Total Cash Accounted For	800	1,206 60

I certify that this is a true statement and the accountability consigned to me is as shown on this form:

Signature | Date

PS Form **1412,** February 2014 PSN 7530-01-000-5259

Shannon's Answers for 1908/1908z

1908 WORKSHEET

(1) Correct SSA'S 1412 with RED ink then adjust the Unit Financial Report (1412)

UNIT FORMAT

LOCATION OF ERROR	TYPE	UNIT 1412 CORRECTION	AMOUNT	UNIT 1412 AIC# (that needs corrected)	AMOUNT
RECEIPT	OVERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 247		REDUCE AIC#	
	UNDERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 647		INCREASE AIC#	
DISBURSEMENT	OVERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 647		REDUCE AIC#	
	UNDERREPORTED	INCREASE AIC 247 10.00		INCREASE AIC# 526	10.00

(2) Process form 1908 to correct clerk's accountability on next 1412 report.

SSA's FORMAT

LOCATION OF ERROR	TYPE	SSA's CORRECTION	AMOUNT	SSA's OFFSET AIC#	AMOUNT
RECEIPT	OVERREPORTED	TRUST W/D AIC647		DECREASE AIC 752	
	UNDERREPORTED	CLEAR SUSP AIC247		INCREASE AIC 752	
DISBURSEMENT	OVERREPORTED	CLEAR SUSP AIC247		INCREASE AIC 752	
	UNDERREPORTED	TRUST W/D AIC647	10.00	DECREASE AIC 752	10.00

(3) Fill out & issue 1908 in the format below. (in triplicate); verify that action is taken to clear.

U.S. POSTAL SERVICE
FINANCIAL ADJUSTMENT MEMORANDUM
(Prepare in triplicate: Original and 1 copy to reporting unit.(for SSA) Retain triplicate)

EXAMINATION of the financial report indicated showed discrepancies as described below. If an adjustment is required, please indicate the adjustment made and return the duplicate copy of this memorandum with the next 1412 report.

(Postmaster, Station Mgr., SSA, Military PO,)

Shannon

Financial Report (Check applicable item)	Dated
Form 1412	99/99/9999
Form 8019-mpo	
Bank Deposit Slip	

The deposit shown below indicated this discrepancy:

Form 1412 Date	Amount of Deposit	Amount Verified by Bank

Make the necessary adjustment on your next Form 1412 or Form 8019.

The indicated Form 1412 AIC or Form 8019 Item PLO. Contained this discrepancy:

Date/No.	Explanation
99/99/9999	AIC# 526 (where error was found) Reported on 1412: $ 5.00 Actual: $ 5.00 (Should be 15.00) (amount on supporting document) Difference: $ 10.00

Make These Adjusting Entries

($ amount is from 'difference' in explanation)
AIC# 647 **$** 10.00
(above AIC# should be either 247 or 647)

AIC# 752 **$** 10.00

Sign: verifying adjustment has been made:
Shannon

Date | Prepared by (Unit) | Signature(prepared by)

PS Form 1908Z

PS Form 1908Z 1908 Guide sheet.xls 1908 worksheet

PS Form 3959 (closeout supporting documentation)

In addition to completing PS Form 17 for any stock transfers, Stamp Requisition/Stamp Return, you must complete a PS Form 3959, *Stamp Stock Transactions and Daily Recap* to record manual stock transfers.

All transactions that affect the Unit Reserve stock must be listed on the manual PS Form 3959, *Stamp Stock Transactions and Daily Recap*, such as:

- Stock received from SFS, SSAs, other post offices, and retail floor stock
- Stock returned to the SFS
- Stock shipped to other post offices
- Form 17 requisition that were filled/completed
- Audit results

The Supervisor or Closeout person must ensure that the Total Unit Accountability (PS Form 3959) matches the Consolidated Unit's 1412 AIC 853 (Closing Balance Stamp Accountability) total and the form is properly signed.

You must keep the original PS Form 3959 as supporting documentation for the unit's daily PS Form 1412.

NOTE**:** When you complete your final Closeout for the unit in POS offices, the system automatically generates a PS For 3958, Unit Reserve Stamp Stock Transaction Record for your review and signature.

Touring PS Form 3959

The PS Form 3959 is divided into the following 3 sections:

- Unit Reserve Stamp Stock
- Daily Recap
- Total Unit Accountability

Unit Reserve Stamp Stock

A summary of unit reserve stamp stock activity, starting with an opening balance and ending with the closing balance amount. This form replaced the previously-used PS Form 3958, *Unit Reserve Stamp Stock Transaction Record*.

The unit reserve stamp stock reflects stock that's being carried in the unit reserve and the opening and closing balance will be the same in lines 1, 7 and 15 if there is no activity in unit reserve.

Daily Recap

A detailed activity report of the unit reserve stock and retail floor stock, listed separately. Anything with an 853 balance will be recorded in this recap.

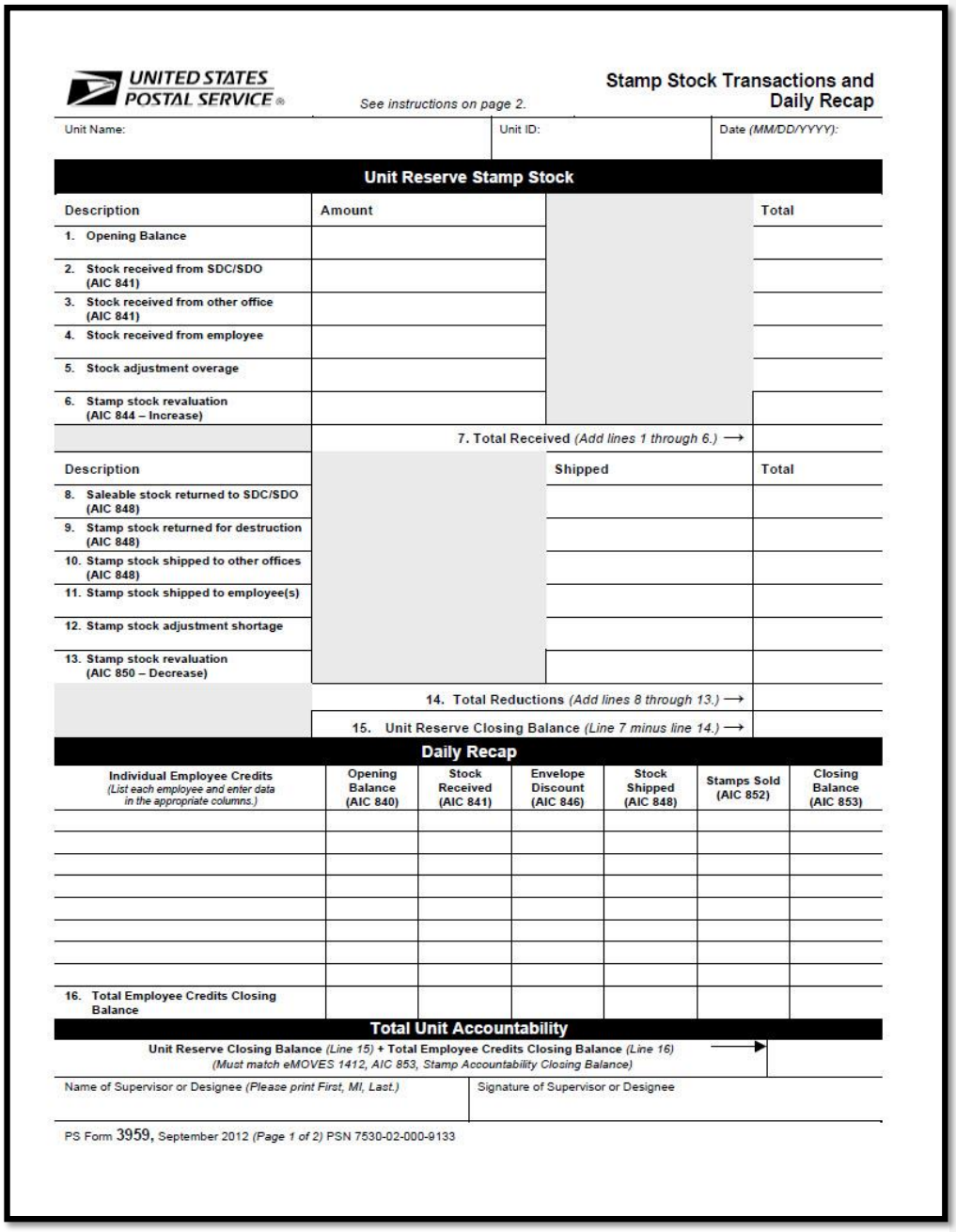
The Daily Recap is considered to be your floor stock, unit reserve, and any activity in AIC 841 (stamp received), AIC 846 (envelope discount), AIC 848 (stock shipped), and AIC 852 (stamp sold) should be subtracted from the opening balance and entered under the applicable column on line 16 under Total Employee Credits Closing Balance.

Total Unit Accountability

Provides the total amount of unit reserve stamp stock closing balance plus the total employee credit closing balance.

Total Unit Accountability is a combination of your unit reserve closing balance (line 15) and your unit's retail floor stock (line 16). **Note, for non POS units it would be the individual employee credit instead of retail floor stock.

PS Form 3959



UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

See instructions on page 2.

Stamp Stock Transactions and Daily Recap

Unit Name:	Unit ID:	Date (MM/DD/YYYY):

Unit Reserve Stamp Stock

Description	Amount	Total
1. Opening Balance		
2. Stock received from SDC/SDO (AIC 841)		
3. Stock received from other office (AIC 841)		
4. Stock received from employee		
5. Stock adjustment overage		
6. Stamp stock revaluation (AIC 844 – Increase)		
7. Total Received *(Add lines 1 through 6.)* →		

Description	Shipped	Total
8. Saleable stock returned to SDC/SDO (AIC 848)		
9. Stamp stock returned for destruction (AIC 848)		
10. Stamp stock shipped to other offices (AIC 848)		
11. Stamp stock shipped to employee(s)		
12. Stamp stock adjustment shortage		
13. Stamp stock revaluation (AIC 850 – Decrease)		
14. Total Reductions *(Add lines 8 through 13.)* →		
15. Unit Reserve Closing Balance *(Line 7 minus line 14.)* →		

Daily Recap

Individual Employee Credits *(List each employee and enter data in the appropriate columns.)*	Opening Balance (AIC 840)	Stock Received (AIC 841)	Envelope Discount (AIC 846)	Stock Shipped (AIC 848)	Stamps Sold (AIC 852)	Closing Balance (AIC 853)
16. Total Employee Credits Closing Balance						

Total Unit Accountability

Unit Reserve Closing Balance *(Line 15)* **+ Total Employee Credits Closing Balance** *(Line 16)* →
(Must match eMOVES 1412, AIC 853, Stamp Accountability Closing Balance)

Name of Supervisor or Designee *(Please print First, MI, Last.)*	Signature of Supervisor or Designee

PS Form 3959, September 2012 *(Page 1 of 2)* PSN 7530-02-000-9133

Instructions for Completing PS Form 3959, Unit Reserve Stamp Stock Transaction Record

Unit Reserve Stamp Stock:

- Enter Opening Balance in Line 1 in the Amount and Total columns. Amount is located on the Unit 1412 Daily Financial Report in the Stamp Accountability section on AIC 840 $60,000.
- Enter amounts received in Lines 2–6. (If no transfers were completed, then this section remains blank.)
- Add the amounts in Lines 1–6 and enter in Line 7, Total Received $60,000.(If your unit did not have any of the transactions described in Lines 2-6, then the Opening Balance and Total amount can be recorded in the Total column next to Line 7, Total Received.)
- Enter amounts shipped in Lines 8–13. (Record the total amount of stamp stock transferred to employee(s) in Line 11 (Stamp stock shipped to employee (s) under the Shipped and Total columns. If no transfers were completed, then this section remains blank.)
- Add the amounts in Lines 8–13 and enter in Line 14, Total Reductions – will be blank for this activity. (If the unit did not have any reductions, this section remains blank. Line 15 should have the same amount as was previously entered for Line 7.)

Closing Balance:

- Subtract Line 7; Total Received, from Line 14, Total Reductions.
- Enter amount in Line 15, Closing Balance – still $60,000. (This amount will equal your Opening Balance minus the total amount of Stamp stock shipped to employee(s).

Daily Recap:

- List the name of each employee in the Individual Employee Credits column – Shannon is the only individual for our activity. Refer to Shannon's 1412 for amounts.
- For each employee, enter stamp stock credit activities in these columns:
  - Opening Balance $2,000.
  - Stock Received - blank. (Enter amount that was shipped to each employee, in this scenario, this will be their Opening Balance (AIC 840)
  - Stock Shipped – blank.

  - Stamps Sold (Enter amount of Total Sales (AIC 852) - $488.50.
  - Closing Balance (Subtract the Stock Received (AIC 841) from the Stamps Sold (AIC 852) to obtain the Closing Balance (AIC 853) - $1511.50

- In Line 16, Total Employee Credits, add the totals for each column.

Total Unit Accountability:

- Add Line 15, Unit Reserve Closing Balance, to Line 16, Total Employee Credits Closing Balance - $61,511.50.
- Make sure the Total Unit Accountability matches the Consolidated Unit 1412 AIC 853.

PS Form 3959 Answer Sheet

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

See instructions on page 2.

Stamp Stock Transactions and Daily Recap

Unit Name:	Unit ID:	Date *(MM/DD/YYYY)*:

Unit Reserve Stamp Stock

Description	Amount	Total
1. Opening Balance	60,000 00	60,000 00
2. Stock received from SDC/SDO (AIC 841)		
3. Stock received from other office (AIC 841)		
4. Stock received from employee		
5. Stock adjustment overage		
6. Stamp stock revaluation (AIC 844 – Increase)		
	7. Total Received *(Add lines 1 through 6.)* →	60,000 00

Description	Shipped	Total
8. Saleable stock returned to SDC/SDO (AIC 848)		
9. Stamp stock returned for destruction (AIC 848)		
10. Stamp stock shipped to other offices (AIC 848)		
11. Stamp stock shipped to employee(s)		
12. Stamp stock adjustment shortage		
13. Stamp stock revaluation (AIC 850 – Decrease)		
	14. Total Reductions *(Add lines 8 through 13.)* →	
	15. Unit Reserve Closing Balance *(Line 7 minus line 14.)* →	60,000 00

Daily Recap

Individual Employee Credits *(List each employee and enter data in the appropriate columns.)*	Opening Balance (AIC 840)	Stock Received (AIC 841)	Envelope Discount (AIC 846)	Stock Shipped (AIC 848)	Stamps Sold (AIC 852)	Closing Balance (AIC 853)
Retail Floor Stock	2,000.00				488.50	1,511.50
16. Total Employee Credits Closing Balance	2,000.00				488.50	1,511.50

Total Unit Accountability

Unit Reserve Closing Balance *(Line 15)* **+ Total Employee Credits Closing Balance** *(Line 16)* *(Must match eMOVES 1412, AIC 853, Stamp Accountability Closing Balance)* →	61,511.50

Name of Supervisor or Designee *(Please print First, MI, Last.)*	Signature of Supervisor or Designee

PS Form **3959,** September 2012 *(Page 1 of 2)* PSN 7530-02-000-9133

Summary

- **The PS Form 1412**, *Daily Unit Financial Report* is the daily financial report used to report all of an SSA's daily financial transactions. Your ability to close out the unit and make adjustments is important to the financial viability of your unit. The form provides a running record of receipt controls, stamp accountability, and cash retained. This form is completed everyday business is conducted at the retail counter.
- LSSAs should never guess when it comes to correcting errors on 1412s. Use the Accountability Adjustment Table for Errors Corrected at Unit Level. It will help in determining what is over reported and under reported.
- **PS Form 1908/1908z** - *Financial Adjustment Memorandum* (supporting documentation) is issued to an employee to notify him/her about a shortage or overage "expense" (financial difference). It also provides instructions to the employee about how to clear/offset the "expense."
- You must complete a **PS Form 3959**, *Stamp Stock Transactions and Daily Recap* to record manual stock transfers. All transactions that affect the Unit Reserve stock must be listed on the manual PS Form 3959, *Stamp Stock Transactions and Daily Recap.*

Module 6: Customer Service and Revenue Generation

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Deliver outstanding customer service by developing positive customer interactions to improve customer satisfaction and the total customer experience at USPS.
- Understand the importance of Revenue Generation
- Understand the importance of Labor Distribution and Operation Codes for earning revenue and earning Time by following the POS Workflow
- Build a team around unit goals
- Be a knowledgeable resource to customers, peers and supervisors

Time Allocated for Module:

- 2 Hours

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion
- Group Activity

Summary:

- What Makes a Great Customer Experience
- Using GIST
- Conducting Successful Retail Sales Transactions
- Revenue Reporting and Revenue Generation
- Labor Distribution and Operation Codes
- Building the Team Around Unit Goals
- Knowledge is Power

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- Projector, Ace computer, PowerPoint presentation
- Rip chart

What Makes a Great Customer Experience?

Customer Service and a Knowledgeable Team

Customer service is providing a service while customer satisfaction is the result of excellent customer service. One is a cause, while the other is the effect.

Our goal is to increase customer satisfaction; therefore we must provide excellent customer service. As an LSSA your goal should be to foster a culture of customer responsiveness and world class customer service.

Think of a positive and negative customer service experience you had as a consumer. This could have been at a restaurant or shopping at a store. As you do, keep in mind two things,

1) What did the provider do to make it a great or poor experience?

2) How did their effort make you feel?

For each incident keep in mind the aspects that made it a positive or negative experience.

Activity: Positive versus Negative Customer Experience

Notice how some common themes were specific to each positive and negative experience? As mentioned in module 3 on Communication eye contact, body language, and listening play a pivotal role in both positive and negative customer experiences.

When asked about products and services, answer the customer questions completely. Knowing USPS products and providing solutions is a key to meeting our customers' need. It also opens the door to providing extra value solutions.

Often times, team members are also company consumers. Since they use the products they can speak more specifically to a customer about the product.

Consumers as well as employees

If you enjoy a product or service we provide, maybe our customers would too. This also allows you to add a personal touch to the service you're providing.

What products do you use the most and would suggest to a customer?

As LSSAs, we can find out which USPS products or services we use or have used in the past. Are we using the products we are selling? Do they know all the advantages of the products we sell?

Value of the transactions

There should be an added value to every transaction and USPS customers should feel pleased with each transaction. Offering insurance protects the customer's shipment, while using the SSK helps the customer get in and out of the post office quicker.

Activity: Brainstorming

Brainstorming Exercise

Think of as many ways as possible to create a culture of customer responsiveness at your respective unit. The main questions to consider are:

1. What can I do to help our unit provide excellent customer service?

2. What can I do to get the team/unit to have the same mindset?

3. What ideas can I take to my supervisor to improve customer service?

Great customer service starts by focusing on delivering exceptional service. Exceptional service builds customer loyalty and relationships that keep them coming back.

In order to ensure repeat customers who purchase our products and use our services, we have to make them happy by meeting or exceeding their needs.

Great customer service allows us to grow the customer base for new business, especially if those customers recommend us to others.

So why is it important to provide such outstanding service? Because research tells us that retail customers stop doing business with a company because:

- The sales associate was rude (73 percent)
- Their issues weren't resolved quickly (55 percent)
- The person assisting them did not have knowledge of products or services (51 percent).

The customer experience that you provide should always include providing friendly, knowledgeable support and resolution of customer issues in a timely manner. If we have good customer experiences, we have a customer for life. **If we lose a customer, it's hard to get them back since they have other options.**

Using GIST

As LSSAs you can enhance the customers' retail counter experience and support sales strategies by practicing the **Greet, Inquire, Suggest, and Thank (GIST)** principles. By remembering to use the GIST principles, you can engage our customers during each visit.

"G" – Greeting Customers

Did you know that greeting a customer sets the tone for the entire transaction? A pleasant greeting and eye contact encourages open communication with customers. Greet the customer by name if you know it. Being attentive throughout the entire transaction tells your customers that they are important and that you value their business. An LSSA in complete uniform also communicates trust in your ability to provide reliable service in a professional manner. It promotes the USPS brand.

Note: As LSSAs you routinely figure out ways to assist SSA's in not being robotic when delivering the standard retail transaction script.

The greatest concern of the Postal Service is the safety of Postal Service employees, the general public, and civil aviation. It is important that all employees responsible for the acceptance of mail conduct a thorough examination of the article and determine contents by asking the required "HAZMAT" question. Each time you prevent a non-mailable or improperly prepared article from entering the mailstream, you prevent a potential incident and protect employees and customers.

Note: Retail personnel at non-POS One offices are required to ask customers mailing parcels this hazmat question. Those with POS, it's on the customer display unit for the customer to respond. LSSA and SSA's should only respond on behalf of the customer when they are unable to themselves.

"I" – Inquiring

Customer needs change every day. By inquiring, we engage customers to better understand their mailing needs. What they needed yesterday may not be the same as what they need today. We have a variety of products and services which are not easily understood by many of our customers. Ask questions like, "would you like to purchase insurance to give you peace of mind in case your package is lost or damaged?" It is important to communicate with each customer and to listen carefully to what they say.

"S" – Suggesting

It is the LSSA's responsibility to recommend options that will best meet customers' mailing needs. Suggesting and promoting our premier products and services is one of the best ways to ensure customer satisfaction while offering excellent value. Suggesting extra services such as USPS Tracking and Insurance adds value by providing customers with peace of mind since customers will know when their packages arrive and that they are insured against damage or loss. Suggesting additional products or services adds value by saving customers an extra trip to the Post Office.

Remember - customers rely on you, the retail expert, to suggest Postal products and services, and to explain their features and benefits.

"T" – Thanking

When we were children, we learned the importance of saying "thank you." Have you ever been in a retail establishment and weren't thanked when the transaction was completed? Did you feel unappreciated? Did you feel like going back?

It is important that our customers know how much we appreciate their business. Satisfied customers are repeat and loyal customers who support our business and keep us profitable. Always end the transaction in a pleasant manner by saying "Thank you" or "Thank you for choosing the US Postal Service" and always provide customers with their receipt. For those who have POS -, remind them we want their feedback and circle the POS survey website.

You are not just selling our products and services, but the experience which the customer will evaluate during and after the interaction. How you respond to a customer's questions and/or concerns has a long lasting impact on the relationship and can either ensure a customer for life or one that will never return.

Selling the experience can be a great opportunity to salvage and even improve customer relationships; but only if you act thoughtfully and with intention.

Activity: GIST Role Play

Conducting Successful Retail Sales Transactions

A successful sales transaction is one in which you and the customer make an informed, mutually beneficial decision. As a Lead Sales and Services Associate (LSSA), it is your job to direct and manage the customer experience so that this outcome is achieved.

Since customers usually consider more than one need when making decisions, the skills of probing and supporting may be used repeatedly during a transaction. Once you have greeted the customer, gathered information about the customer's needs, and provided information about how you can satisfy that need by offering USPS products and services, you gather and provide information about additional customer needs and the appropriate USPS product and/or service that matches that need. Then, at the appropriate time, you close/complete the transaction.

As a Lead Sales and Services Associate, you should differentiate our products and services through their value, not solely on any price advantage. This selling strategy is recommended because in the absence of value, price usually becomes the determining decision criteria. Unless the product is positioned as the lowest price available, you will often lose the sale.

Solution/product differentiating is based on meeting and exceeding customer needs and expectations. The focus is always on the customer, not on the competition. When presenting the value of USPS products and services, you align that value with the customer's needs. This becomes your value proposition; the value to the customer of the product's features and benefits.

Selling Maximum Value

Selling maximum value to customers by matching their needs should be the objective of every LSSA. Premier expedited products such as Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail receive special attention and focus when being processed, transported, dispatched, and delivered. If speedy delivery of a package is important to the customer, then either Priority Mail Express or Priority Mail is the answer.

Adding Extra Services to a package sale is like putting icing on the cake. Customers want to know: the status of their item (USPS Tracking), who signed for the item (Signature Confirmation), that it arrived safely (Insurance), and to have a record of delivery (Return Receipt).

Combining expedited shipping products with Extra Services offers maximum value for customers. When customers consider our Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail competitive prices, Flat-Rate product options, and complimentary shipping supplies, they will know they are receiving maximum value that cannot be beat.

The best way to increase customer satisfaction is to provide the customer with the postal product that fits their need. Customers look to you as the retail expert to be knowledgeable about what we have to offer and to recommend the appropriate product and service for them.

Multicultural Outreach

Outreach contains information, guides, and product fact sheets in several languages to assist those who use USPS products and services but are not native English speakers.

The Human Resources Inclusiveness website includes additional information such as:

- Translation Aids: Postal Products and Services Translator
- Product Fact Sheets
- Extra Services Translation Guides
- Passport Fairs and special events

- DMM 100, 100C, and 100S - *A Customer's Guide to Mailing* (English, Chinese, and Spanish)
- Translated Posters and Publications

Postal Products and Services Translator

The Postal Products and Services Translator is a great tool to support communication with our multicultural retail customers. This four-page information sheet highlights our major products and services, and provides responses to common questions asked at the retail counter. Translators are available in Arabic, Chinese, French, German, Hindi, Korean, Polish, Portuguese, Russian, Spanish, and Vietnamese.

Product Fact Sheets

Product fact sheets contain information on U.S. Postal Service products. These fact sheets provide our non-English speaking customers with updated information about our products and how they can meet the customers' mailing needs.

Extra Services Translation Guides

The Extra Services Translation Guides are designed to provide our non-English speaking customers with step by step instructions on how to properly complete U.S. Postal Service Extra Service forms.

HAZMAT Question Translator

The HAZMAT Question Translator provides translations in 23 languages, including English, Arabic, Chinese, and Spanish.

Need Satisfaction Selling

Has anyone ever heard the term need satisfaction selling? Let’s start by defining that phrase and seeing how it applies to you as an LSSA. In its simplest form, need satisfaction selling is the understanding of a customer’s needs through the use of probing questions and careful listening. Remember, that the customer has both stated and unstated needs. The stated needs are obvious as the customer provides that information during the initial discussion. But, it is often the discovery of those unstated needs that identifies what product or service will provide the customer with a mailing solution and satisfy their need.

Need satisfaction selling is based on the simple recognition that customers buy products to satisfy their needs. Needs are the driving force behind a customer’s willingness to interact with you, learn about Postal products, and make a purchase commitment.

You're able to satisfy a customer's needs when your product and organization have features which provide benefits that are important to the customer.



Generally speaking, the customer is the expert on his or her circumstances and needs. You are the expert on the features and benefits our products offer. It is through dialogue with the customer that you reach a mutual understanding of all these elements.

Recognizing Needs

Often times, customers are not sure of the right product or service to satisfy their need. They will look to you, the LSSA, to provide that information and make a recommendation. Customers will try to explain what they need. Listen for those words or phrases which tell you what that person desires; what is commonly called the language of needs. The language of needs can help you to uncover the customer's true need; providing the best option, and a potential opportunity to sell another postal product or service.

You do not have knowledge of a customer's needs. Only the customer can tell you what their needs are. However, you can be reasonably sure a customer has a need when they use the language of needs. They use words and phrases that express a desire.

Some examples may be:

"I want . . . . ."

"I need . . . . ."

"I'd like . . . . ."

"I'm looking for . . . . ."

"I'm interested in . . . . ."

"I wish . . . . ."

"I hope . . . . ."

"What matters is . . . . ."

"It's important to . . . . ."

"My objective . . . . ."

"My goal . . . . ."

"I must . . . . ."

When you interact with your customer, it's important to listen for and recognize the language of needs. If you do not, you might make unwarranted assumptions about what a customer is looking for and waste time talking about things in which they are not interested.

Premier Products

Did you know the Postal Service was first to introduce Express Mail (now called Priority Mail Express) as a new class of mail?

Priority Mail Express became so popular that competitors emerged and began selling overnight service too. They recognized the value of expedited services and entered this competitive marketplace.

Do we recognize the value of our premier products and offer them to our customers?

When recommending shipping services to customers, you should begin by offering Priority Mail Express for domestic shipping or Global Express Guaranteed for international shipping. Priority Mail Express provides tracking ability, which allows customers to monitor the progress of their shipment throughout the delivery process. Always explain the features and benefits to ensure that customers are aware of their options. Remember, when selling Priority Mail Express, always inform customers of the insurance and tracking features included with the price. This allows them to make an informed shipping decision

Priority Mail Express is automatically insured up to $100 against loss or damage. Additional insurance can be purchased. Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail generate a much higher contribution (profit) per piece than other domestic package products. Global Express Guaranteed is the highest profit per piece product in the Postal Service. Premier products provide better value-added service which equates to satisfied customers who will return again and again.

Remember, the lowest cost is not always the best value for our customers!

Even though a customer has not asked for a product, when the opportunity exists recommend particular products such as: PO Box, Passport, GXG, EDDM, Insurance, Registered, Certified, Signature Confirmation, ReadyPost, and Greeting Card.

Extra Services

USPS Tracking is an inexpensive, user-friendly service that allows a customer to verify delivery. This service is included for Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, and Standard Post. Additionally, Priority Mail Express includes $100 insurance and Priority Mail includes $50 insurance.

Customers trust us to protect their mail and provide quality service. After it has been determined that a customer wants to ship a package as Priority Mail, you should offer extra services such as, additional insurance. Insurance provides the customer peace of mind in case of loss or damage. When you offer additional insurance to every customer who mails a package, you will be offering them an extra service to meet their needs.

Additional Products

In today's world, customers are often in a hurry and may forget to ask for additional products. Do they need stamps, packaging or shipping (ReadyPost) products, a PO Box, passports, or money orders? Our customers appreciate it when we remind them of other things they might need while they are at the Post Office. Make sure customers are completely satisfied when they walk out the door.

Retail employees need to be observant of customer needs when recommending additional products.

Revenue Reporting

Category	Attributes	Actual for Year to Date
Walk-In Rev (WIR)	Total	10,695,738,731.89
	Priority Mail Express Stamps	17,437,930.90
	Priority Mail Stamps	37,409,142.15
	All Other Stamps	4,891,198,471.68
	Priority Mail Express	474,132,130.79
	Priority Mail Express WIR Txn	22,623,170.00
	Priority Mail Express Full Postage Affixed and EMCA Txn	3,011,402.00
	Priority Mail	1,643,415,408.04
	Priority Mail WIR Txn	182,938,847.00
	Priority Mail Full Postage Affixed Txn	7,409,250.00
	First-Class	442,698,734.79
	Standard Post	448,914,803.11
	Standard Post WIR Txn	33,574,237.00
	Standard Post Postage Affixed Txn	586,013.00
	International Mailing	692,441,037.05
	Special Services	454,236,153.96
	PO Box Revenue	862,276,398.78
	Consumer Products Total	151,089,028.53
	Branded & Promotional Products	4,704,644.93
	Greeting Cards/Stationary Products	9,343,277.54
	Mail-Related Products	1,424,427.15
	Mail & Ship (ReadyPost) Products	123,128,700.40
	Philatelic Products	11,549,002.11
	Retail Services	408,128,488.33
	Passport Fees and Photo Services	169,456,730.00
Operational Data	Customer Visits	934,976,545.00
	WIR Customer Visits	695,345,353.00
	Total Transactions (Rev & Non-Rev)	1,800,819,635.00
	POS ONE Terminal Hours	74,962,092.16
	Retail Units	17,547.00
Business Days	Business Days	5,111,028.00
Retail Productivity	WIR / POS ONE Terminal Hr	142.68
	WIR / Customer Visits	11.44
	WIR / WIR Customer Visits	15.38
	% PO Box Occupancy	65.54

Revenue Generation Matching Exercise

Write the revenue amount generated for each product and services listed in the corresponding box.~~Match the revenue amount for each category by writing the letter of the revenue item into the corresponding box.~~

Products & Services	Revenue Generated
1. 2013 Walk-In Rev (WIR) Total	
2. All Other Stamps	
3. Priority Mail	
4. P.O. Box Revenue	
5. Priority Mail Express	
6. Special Services (i.e. Insurance, Registered, Certified)	

*Actual For Year to Date-Documentation Source-RDM National Flash

Revenue Generation

The total national Walk-in Revenue (WIR) for fiscal year 2013 totaled **$10.7 billion**. Our highest grossing products were stamp sales (including Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail). As indicated on the revenue chart, our products and services produce a large percentage of our revenue.

LSSAs play a vital role in revenue generation by providing excellent customer service. Happy, satisfied customers are more likely to return and share their experience with others.

LSSAs impact revenue performance by offering products and services that customers find of value and are willing to purchase. By offering these products and services, SSAs and LSSAs (for fiscal year 2013) were able to increase sales for Priority Mail by 7%, Priority Mail Express stamps by 4.3%, and P.O. Box revenue by 3.5% over the same period for last year.

The Importance of Revenue Generation

Building business relationships with customers keeps them coming back. You have the opportunity to create a relationship with each customer by fitting their need with just the right service. While your retail transaction and your individual style may vary from other LSSAs', you should interact with customers based on that customer's needs. The customer in front of you is the most important individual. Always remember, you never get a second chance to make a first impression. Engaging our customers will assist you with the necessary steps to ensure that customers are offered maximum value during their package transactions.

As a Lead, it is important for you to rally the unit to help achieve unit revenue goals collectively and to take ownership of the unit's success.

In the eLearning course "Advancing the Retail Customer Experience" the components of the RCE where listed. What were they?

We now know that revenue generation is directly tied to customer service, communication, and product knowledge. The next step is to think about what LSSAs can do to build a cohesive unit.

As the LSSA, how can you get the Sales Associate team to understand the overall unit goals and the Postal Service's goal of improving the customer experience and generating revenue?

Do they understand that without repeat customers and new business, a business will not be profitable for long? How are you going to create an environment where SSA's feel free to discuss new ideas and ask questions? How are you going to make them feel like they are viable members of a team?

When discussing these items with your unit, how do you create team unity and make these goals your unit's goals?

Building the Team Around Unit Goals

This activity is to identify an area where your unit had a lower score and then work together to identify ways to improve.

Work in groups to brainstorm how to speak to your unit about a specific RCE component. Discuss how the gap could affect the customer experience and revenue. One group will discuss wait time in line the other will discuss promotion/merchandising.

Unit Goals & Team Building

Service talks are team building opportunities. It is a vehicle to rally the team. The previous activity prepared you to deliver a service talk. Here are a few tips to make them effective:

- Discuss goals as a unit.
- Always be inclusive and emphasize positive reinforcement.
- Share results as a team.
- Make the results more collective so to not single out one person. Keep everyone involved.
- Use "we" and emphasize how everyone is relying on the other members. We all have a role and it is important to the success of the unit.
- Solicit ideas from the team and get their thoughts on how your unit can attain team goals. The team input matters. Ask if they noticed any trends or have insight towards attaining revenue targets.

Service Talk Activity

If you could select three or four general items or talking points on various types of revenue generation, what would they be?

Advancing the Retail Customer Experience eLearning course mentioned the importance of appearance. First impressions are critical and you have just a few seconds to make a good first impression. When discussing appearance, remember the three Ps Personal, Professional, and Postal.

Service Talks

Key Talking Points

1. Appearance is Everything – it's our brand.
    - Personal: Your appearance and demeanor.
    - Professional: Your Post Office.
    - Does your Post Office present an inviting atmosphere?
    - Postal: Products and Services.
    - Do you offer what the customer needs or do you offer what you think they need?

The second talking point refers to being knowledgeable. The eLearning course mentioned research that showed 51% of retail customers stopped doing business with a company because the person assisting them did not have knowledge of products or services

Knowledge is Power

Key Talking Points

2. Knowledge is Power
    - The more we know about our products and services, the better prepared we are to meet our customer's need and exceed their expectations.
    - Customers look to you as an expert on Postal products and services.

Added Value is Key

Key Talking Points

3. Added Value is Key
    - Differentiate products and services through their value, not solely on any price advantage.
    - Always focus on the customer, not the competition.
    - Align value with the customer's needs.

Our customers have mailing and shipping choices as times have changed. It is imperative to provide our customers with choices for purchasing postal products and services; especially when they need access beyond normal hours.

Alternative Access Channels

Key Talking Points

4. Alternative Access Channels
    - USPS.com
    - Stamps by Mail/Phone
    - Self Service Kiosks (SSKs)
    - Contract Postal Units (CPUs)
    - Village Post Office (VPO)
    - Commercial Mail Receiving Agent (CMRA)
    - Retail Partners
    - Approved Postal Providers / Shippers

Click-N-Ship revenues totaled $510 million for 2013 and SSKs brought in $457 million that same year. We have to explain to our team that these alternative streams are part of the big picture. The fact that they are bringing in these revenue streams demonstrate our customers like having options.

Revenue generation highly impacts you, USPS, and our collective future.

Earning Revenue and Earning Time by following the POS Workflow

Labor Distribution Codes 45 and 48

It's important to understand the impact of labor distribution codes (LDC) 45 and 48 in the retail unit.

WOS Time Factors are the average time it takes to sell a product or service. It includes the pre-visit time, visit time, tender exchange, and the post-visit time. Pre-visit time is the time that it takes the customer to approach the window and communicate their desire to the window clerk. Visit time is the time from the first keystroke on the POS One terminal to the keystroke that begins the printing of the receipt. Tender exchange includes the transfer of payment and change, if any. Post-visit time includes the visit ending conversation.

The LDC 45 WOS Ancillary option provides a list of activities that are performed as part of LDC 45. The LDC WOS Ancillary (frequently referred to as "soft time") earned workload is in addition to the workload calculated for transactions. 33% of earned transaction time is allocated for Ancillary activities; i.e. for every 45 minutes of earned transaction time a unit earns an additional 15 minutes.

At the bottom of the LDC 45 WOS Ancillary Report you will find the Total LDC WOS Ancillary Hours for the period selected and the LDC 45 WOS Ancillary Minutes per day. The Total WOS LDC 45 Ancillary hours is the sum of the WOS Ancillary minutes per day, divided by 60 minutes then multiplied by the number of days in the selected report period.

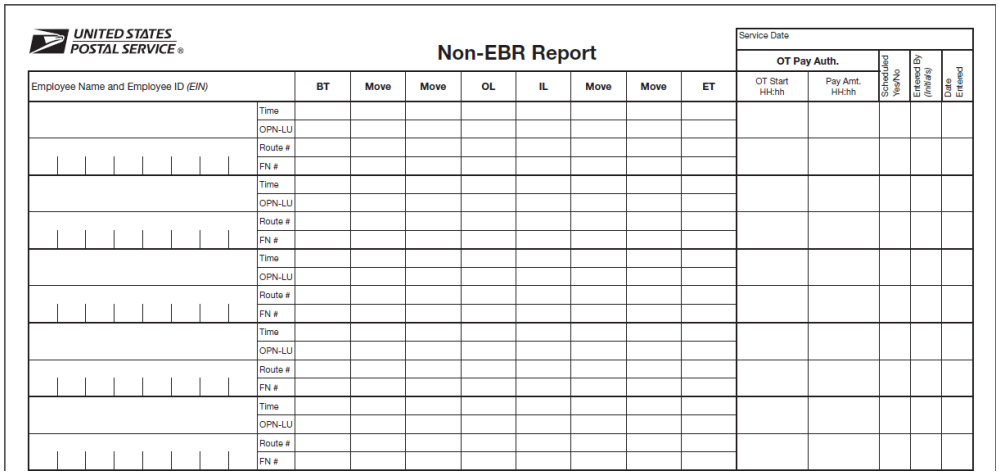
Earned work hours are compared to actual work hours as a performance measurement of a retail unit and used to determine work hour budgets for subsequent future periods. It is critical that retail employees use the proper clock rings so time used for specific retail tasks is accurately recorded and credited to the correct Labor Distribution Codes (LDC) in which the work is being accomplished. LDC 45 and LDC 48 are just two of the most common LDC's used by SSAs and LSSAs.

All non-supervisory work hours of employees serving customers at windows, and other activities associated with the support of window services should be directed to LDC 45 work hours. For example, this is accomplished by retail employees clocking into Operation 355 or Operation 568 when completing related window service tasks such as finalizing the day by counting their money, preparing their 1412 or locking their drawer away in the safe. Another situation might be when Operation 352 is used by an LSSA performing Lobby Assistance so the time is directed back to LDC 45.

An instance of using the proper Operation to move work hours to LDC 48 might be when an LSSA clocks into Operation 558 to verify individual clerk cash, receipts and checks, prepares the office deposit or files receipts and supporting documentation.

Whether work hours are being channeled to LDC 45 or LDC 48 it is important to know the correct Operations used to move hours to the appropriate Labor Distribution Code.

There may be times when you are switching between operations and are unable to swipe your card to signify this change for various reasons. It is during these times the PS Form 1261becomes handy. This form allows you to document the change and submit to your supervisor for entry later. By doing this, the TACS coordinator is able to record the proper work hours and assigns work credits where they belong. Since these hours determine staffing at an office, it is imperative they are entered correctly



UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Non-EBR Report

Employee Name and Employee ID *(EIN)*		BT	Move	Move	OL	IL	Move	Move	ET	Service Date / OT Pay Auth. OT Start HH:hh	OT Pay Auth. Pay Amt. HH:hh	Scheduled Yes/No	Entered By (HHard)	Date Entered
	Time													
	OPN-LU													
	Route #													
	FN #													
	Time													
	OPN-LU													
	Route #													
	FN #													
	Time													
	OPN-LU													
	Route #													
	FN #													
	Time													
	OPN-LU													
	Route #													
	FN #													
	Time													
	OPN-LU													
	Route #													
	FN #													

This is a snapshot of the PS Form 1261. To complete this form enter your name, employee ID (EIN) and then all the requested changes made that you were unable to swipe. This is then handed to your supervisor for entry when complete.

LDC 45 window services consist of all non-supervisory hours of employees serving customers at windows, and other activities in support of window services.

LDC 45: Window Services

All non-supervisory hours of employees serving customers at windows, and other activities in support of window services.

1. Advance deposits

2. Audits: SSA's cash retained and money orders
3. Caller mail pick-up at window
4. Change orders requested by SSAs
5. CODs: acceptance and delivery
6. Clerk set-up: open and close
7. Information/directions
8. Lobby Director
9. Mail pick-ups at the window
10. Passport application, fees and transmittal form
11. Passport photos
12. Sales of all postal products and services
13. Service/safety talks at the window
14. Stamps by Mail/Fax
15. Stamp stock: requesting and verification (local Form 17)
16. Stocking forms, lobby supplies and POP materials

Below is a list of the most common operation numbers.

Common LDC 45 Operations #'s

Set UP Counter - OPERATION # 355 or OPERATION #568

Window Activity - OPERATION # 355 or OPERATION #568

Close Counter Final 1412 - OPERATION # 355 or OPERATION #568

Advance Deposit - OPERATION # 355 or OPERATION #568

Audit Stamp Credits - OPERATION # 355 or OPERATION #568

Stock Requisition - OPERATION # 355 or OPERATION #568

Window Services/Operations - OPERATION # 355 or OPERATION #568

Lobby Assistance - OPERATION # 352

LDC 48: Administrative/Miscellaneous Duties

LDC 48 administrative/miscellaneous duties consists of all non-supervisory hours of customer service employees assigned to dispatch activities, office work, recordkeeping, and miscellaneous retail activities at stations, branches, and associate offices, including steward's duty time, travel time, and meeting time.

It also includes non-supervisory hours used in support of delivery service, such as working postage due, insured, COD, customs, business reply mail, carrier cage operation, mark up duties (other than CFS sites), and other miscellaneous customer service and clerical activities. Also includes bulk mail acceptance: PS 1412A *Daily Financial Form* consolidation and financial activities in facility without a specified staff.

1. Accountable mail
2. Audits: Retail Floor Stock, Unit Reserve, Unit Cash Reserve, and fixed credits
3. Bank: to replenish change fund (accountability assigned on Form 3369)
4. BRM/postage due
5. Carrier check out/clearing
6. Claims & inquiry processing
7. Collections
8. Copy machine administration
9. Customer meter verification
10. Dispatch
11. Priority Mail Express street delivery by clerks
12. RCU backup transmission support, IRT offices
13. Mark-up, nixie and return to sender mail
14. Open/Close building
15. Phone duties
16. Registry duties
17. Request stock (Retail SDO)
18. Scanning duties in back office
19. Service/Safety talks
20. Supply ordering
21. Timekeeping
22. Trust fund recordkeeping
23. UBBM processing

24. Unit close out, prepare and verify deposit

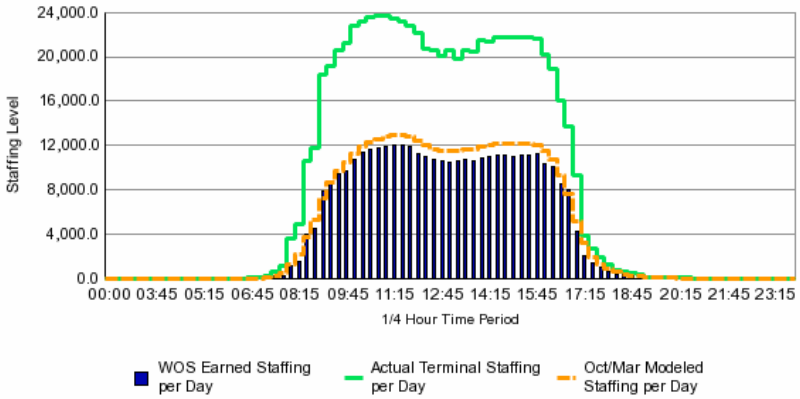
25. Unit consolidation: verify supporting documents and unit reports, filing

The activities associated with these two LDCs are directly tied into the daily duties and responsibilities of both LSSAs and SSAs. You should be familiar with the activities whether you're working the window or providing guidance to SSAs.

As an LSSA, it is important for you to understand that each transaction at the retail counter impacts the amount of revenue earned for the Postal Service but it also affects time earned in LDC 45 Work hours. Work Hours are "earned" with every revenue or non-revenue transaction.

WOS Earned - Actual Staffing Graph

The Actual Terminal Staffing is based on activity at the Front Office Counters and Passport terminals ONLY.



1/4 Hour of Day	WOS Earned Staffing per Day	Actual Terminal Staffing per Day	Oct/Mar Modeled Staffing per Day
10:00	10,755.90	22,814.70	11,221
10:15	11,342.40	23,220.40	11,866
10:30	11,620.00	23,566.00	12,329
10:45	11,751.10	23,667.60	12,622
11:00	11,874.10	23,738.10	12,837
11:15	12,097.40	23,418.50	13,000
11:30	12,068.50	23,208.80	12,995
11:45	11,971.20	22,798.40	12,794
12:00	11,304.20	22,172.40	12,391
12:15	11,022.60	20,696.80	12,016
12:30	10,770.40	20,544.40	11,712
12:45	10,569.50	20,069.60	11,542
13:00	10,529.20	20,606.60	11,483
13:15	10,606.50	19,859.80	11,517
13:30	10,762.40	20,617.00	11,611
13:45	10,609.20	20,452.30	11,711
14:00	10,878.30	21,508.60	11,869

RDM WOS AIC Look-Up Report

Examples of how to convert Time Factors into minutes and seconds:

- **4.77 = 4 minutes + .77 * 60 seconds = 4 minutes, 46 seconds**
- **1.19 = 1 minute + .19 * 60 seconds = 1 minute, 11 seconds**

	Workload New Groups	AIC	Description	Current Time Factor
3	Postage	0007	Forever Stamp Sales, Window Services	0.49
		0015	Global Forever Stamp Sales	0.49
		0084	Breast Cancer Stamp Sales	0.53
4	Retail Services	0100	Domestic Money Order - Value	1.07
		0101	Domestic Money Order - Fee	0.00
		0102	International Money Order - Value	2.16
		0103	International Money Order - Fee	0.00
		0105	Sure Money Sales - Funds (Restricted Entry)	0.60
		0106	Sure Money Sales - Fee (Restricted Entry)	1.82
		0108	Premium Forwarding Service Application Fees	4.40
		0110	Post Office Postage Meters Sales	0.58
7	Mailing & Special Services	1003	Priority Mail	1.18
			Priority Mail Gift Card Flat Rate Envelope	0.69
			Priority Mail International	5.15
		1005	Domestic Signature Confirmation	0.57
		1006	Domestic Insurance	0.90

*** This is only a sample of the WOS AIC Look up Report**

Priority Mail

Priority Mail with Insurance

Priority Mail with Insurance plus a book of stamps

Summary

As a Lead Sales and Services Associate, you have the unique opportunity to help not only improve the customer experience, but also generate revenue for the organization. Using effective sales techniques to identify and meet the customers' mailing needs will help to maintain customers for life.

Take advantage of every opportunity to talk to your customers, ask the right questions, and find the best solution to that customer's needs. Every transaction should end with the customer knowing that the Postal Service offers the best prices with great service performance equating to the best value in the marketplace.

Team building and revenue generation go hand in hand. A unit that works together has a greater chance to meet and exceed unit revenue targets. Your role as an LSSA is to make sure the team understands the importance of revenue goals, has the same common goal, and works together to achieve them.

Always keep the appearance of the lobby inviting and well merchandised. Make sure you display merchandise properly, getting the right product in the right place at the right time. This includes restocking the lobby and conducting your district mandated audits to ensure you have an ample supply of ReadyPost, philatelic merchandise, and greeting cards to meet your customer needs. When switching tasks always be mindful of swiping into the correct code as that is what determines work hours and staffing. If there are times when you cannot make that change, remember to use PS Form 1261 to manually document your LDC and Operational Code. Revenue Generation is everyone's responsibility as shown by the Revenue report, but it also earns time for your unit as shown by the WOS Time Factors report. All these components work together and each has a specific purpose.